

Assignment 2 – Evaluation Report

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Important Notice

We initially planned on evaluating the website *Choice Community*, however due to unforeseen circumstances, we no longer have permission to conduct usability evaluations on the site as per the site owner's request. Hence, our study and analysis of the website was cut-short. We have now switched to evaluating the ***Unimelb Library Website*** instead.

All work relating to *Choice Community* prior to the prohibition of the site can be found in the Appendix section of this report ([see Appendix 2: Final Report on Choice Community](#)).

Executive Summary

The Unimelb Library offers University students a range of resources and services that support them with their academic work. Given that the website is an essential academic tool for many students and staff, ensuring a seamless user experience is key to maintaining high retention. Our team therefore conducted a usability assessment to identify areas for improvement. The evaluation of the site was operated carefully to avoid any ethical issues from arising.

The study involved an online 5-second test in which participants got exactly 5 seconds to view the home page design of the Unimelb Library website and then were subsequently asked to respond to four short-answer survey questions. Furthermore, there was also an in-person usability test in which participants were connected to an eye tracking device and were asked to complete a series of tasks in a lab which had cameras and microphones installed. The session was recorded and for each task, participants were timed. Observations, comments and responses to questions were also noted. All qualitative data were categorised by identifying and grouping those that contained similar or frequently occurring keywords while all quantitative data were averaged.

A total of 14 participants completed the online five-second test and 5 participants took part in the in-person usability test. All participants were University of Melbourne students, making them ideal users for this evaluation. The tasks that participants were asked to complete during the live user testing were all realistic scenarios that a typical user would experience. These include booking a meeting room, finding a guide for APA 7 styling, locating databases, searching for past exams and downloading academic journals.

Based on the data gathered, it was observed that booking a meeting room was the hardest task while finding a guide on APA 7 was the easiest. Generally, participants experienced navigation issues on certain areas of the website and there were a number of elements or features on the site that were not clearly visible or discoverable to participants. Additionally, the website does not provide sufficient feedback or confirmation during the database lookup processes and there was no clear guide on how to book a meeting space. Despite these issues, the website had an overall positive user experience according to the responses from the SUS questionnaire. The findings for the 5-second test, suggests that upon first impressions, the Unimelb Library website is clear and intuitive as many participants were able to identify key features of the site and had a general understanding of its purpose.

Limitations of this usability assessment include having a small sample size and tasks were not designed to test edge cases. Additionally, requesting participants to 'think aloud,' may slow down the navigation process. Recommendations were mainly about improving the navigation, visibility and feedback of the website. For example, using more intuitive labels such as "Referencing and Citations" instead of "Re:cite", replacing the green 'add' icon with a green 'Select Space' button to make it more clear to users, provide confirmation and error messages for certain processes, adding a progress header to guide users step-by-step in booking a room and making certain icons and buttons more noticeable by increasing the size or relocating it.

Introduction

The Unimelb Library website offers students and staff a wide range of resources and services to support their academic work. University of Melbourne users can search for journals, books, articles, databases, past papers as well as book meeting rooms, stay updated on news and events and access tools such as referencing guides. With so many things to do on the website, navigating around and locating specific resources can be a challenge. Given that the Unimelb Library website is an essential academic tool for many students and staff, ensuring a seamless user experience is key to maintaining high retention. Our team therefore conducted a usability assessment to identify areas for improvement.

The scope of the evaluation involves conducting user tests to see how real users perceive and interact with the Unimelb Library website. This involves getting participants to complete a 5-second test to determine users' impression of the site as well as instructing them to perform a number of tasks on the website to discover any potential issues.

The primary objective is to examine the clarity of the website at first glance and to identify any usability issues relating to navigation, efficiency, effectiveness, utility, learnability and overall satisfaction. If a participant found it difficult to complete a task or is unsure what the website is even about, it would be an indicator that there are some usability issues that need addressing. The team will then provide SMART recommendations to handle these issues, thus helping improve the overall website. All in-person testing was completed in a lab during week 9 semester 2, 2025.

To avoid any ethical issues from arising, participants are informed about the study and are asked to sign a consent form prior to testing. Data collected is anonymised and remains confidential. Furthermore, participants have the freedom to withdraw from the study at any time without consequences.

Method

Online Test

The usability evaluation involved a 5-second test in which participants got exactly 5 seconds to view the home page design of the Unimelb Library website and then were subsequently asked to respond to four survey questions. The test took no more than 5 minutes and it was recommended that participants complete the survey in a quiet area. The questions were short answers and were about participants' overall impressions of the site (e.g., "What is the main thing you can recall?" or "What do you think you can do on this website?"). Data collected from this test were all qualitative and gave us an insight into what users perceived in that short amount of time. To make analysis easier, data items were **categorised** by identifying and grouping those that contained similar or frequently occurring keywords.

The website used to make the 5-second test was [Lyssna.com](https://www.lyssna.com). The test was sent out as a survey link to other University of Melbourne students. Demographic variables such as name, age and gender were automatically anonymised by the testing tool.

Live User Test

The in-person usability test was conducted in a lab where there were cameras and microphones installed. Participants were called in one at a time to do the user testing. The test began by first informing participants about the study followed by asking them to sign a consent form and a 'Participant Profile' table. After that, participants were connected to the Tobii Eye Tracker which tracks the user's eye movements and gaze. Participants were given permission to briefly browse the Unimelb Library website to get comfortable with the site's layout and structure.

After a minute has passed, participants were asked to think aloud while completing a series of tasks on the Unimelb Library website such as booking a meeting room or downloading a specific academic journal. Upon finishing all five tasks, they responded to debriefing questions, which included items from the System Usability Scale (SUS). Once all questions were answered, the test concluded (refer to the 'Test Protocol' section for the entire procedure).

The entire session was recorded so that we could review and analyse how participants interacted and navigated around the website. Data collected from the study included both quantitative and qualitative as well as heat maps from the eye tracker. For each task, participants were timed using the timer on our phone and the results were recorded. This metric was used to measure efficiency. Additionally, at the end of each task, participants were asked to rate the overall difficulty of the task between 1-5 to gauge its overall learnability and user satisfaction. Both these metrics were later **averaged**. Responses to the SUS statements were also **averaged** and these values provided a general consensus of the website.

The qualitative data collected includes observations and comments from participants as well as answers to debrief questions such as “Do you think you would use this website yourself? Why / Why not?” These were all later **grouped** into similar categories/themes for analysis. All data was recorded using the ‘Data Collection Template’ (refer to Appendix).

The user test was a team effort. A facilitator was present to help guide the evaluation. They were also responsible for asking questions and timing participants. There was also a technical assistant who was with the facilitator and they were responsible with the eye tracking and giving out tasks to participants. Furthermore, there was an additional person outside the lab who was responsible for listening in on the conversation and taking down notes as well as observing the participant navigating the website.

Participants

A total of 5 participants took part in the in-person usability test. All participants were male and the average age was 19. Participants were all University of Melbourne students however some were international while others were domestic. Participants were either studying Bachelor of Science or Bachelor of Design. When asked, “How confident are you with using the Unimelb Library Website?,” 60% of participants reported they were unconfident while the other 40% were neutral.

The Unimelb Library website is designed for University of Melbourne students, hence all participants matched the ideal users. Additionally, prior to the usability testing, participants disclosed that they were unconfident with using the website. This makes them suitable to participate in the study because they have less bias or knowledge when it comes to completing certain tasks on the website and usability issues can easily be identified.

Regarding the online testing tool, a total of 14 participants completed the 5-second test survey. The survey link was sent out to several groups of friends but the exact demographics of these participants were not recorded as the survey was completed anonymously. The purpose of the 5-second test was to gauge the overall impression and clarity of the Unimelb Library website, hence there were no ‘ideal users.’ Anyone could complete the survey.

Participant Table

Participant No.	Age	Degree	Australian Citizen	University of Melbourne Student	Confidence Level of Using Library Website
1	20	Science	YES	YES	Unconfident
2	19	Science	YES	YES	Neutral
3	19	Design	YES	YES	Unconfident
4	19	Design	NO	YES	Unconfident
5	18	Science	NO	YES	Neutral

Scenarios

Scenario 1

You are looking to book a study space through the University of Melbourne library website. You start with a new browser tab and are to navigate to the website then through the website book a study space. What steps will you take in order to achieve this?

In this scenario, the ease of navigation is being tested, as well as how intuitive the process of booking a study space is.

Scenario 2

You are doing a university assignment, and are required to use APA 7 style referencing. You are unsure about the fundamentals and the structure of APA 7 referencing, so for accurate and university expected standards, you decide to check the Unimelb library website for information on referencing. Where will you find this information?

This scenario tests the locations and links to key functions of the website, checking the validity of the structure in the page.

Scenario 3

You are a STEM student looking for multiple resources to study mathematics, so you decide to search the university's database in the digital library for resources on "Mathematics". Where will you find this information, and will it be accurate?

This scenario will test how easy it is to find the database page and how accurate the search results for a given query are.

Scenario 4

Exam season is approaching, and you have a chem10003 exam coming up for which you need practice papers. You have not been provided with any so you decide to search the Unimelb library website for past year exams for this subject. Will you be able to locate where past exam papers are located on the website? Can you find the exam papers for this subject?

In this scenario, a core function of the Unimelb library is tested to measure how easy it is to find important resources. It also tests whether the user will know to use the search bar instantly or will they search the rest of the website for a path.

Scenario 5

You want to learn about the relationship between money and happiness, and so you decide to read the book "One More Time, Does Money Buy Happiness" by James Fisher by accessing it through the university digital library, after which you aim to download a pdf copy of it. Where will you search for this book and how will you download it?

Here, the simplicity of the website is being tested, as searching for a book in a digital library should be one of the easiest tasks.

Findings

Across all 5 tests, participants tended to agree on task difficulty, generally finding each task easy or hard as a group. This consensus helped clarify the tasks and therefore the aspects of the website which were weaker and needed an improvement or redesign to increase usability.

It should be noted that an 8 minute time limit was set on all tasks, and if a user went past this time limit with no sign of progress the test for that particular task was to be ended. This was done as none of the tests were designed to take a new user more than 5 minutes, therefore going past 8 minutes would propose that the user is unable to complete the task in a realistic time frame. This in turn would suggest a non-intuitive and poor user experience. Findings with their code number are summarised at the end of this section.

Summary of Tasks

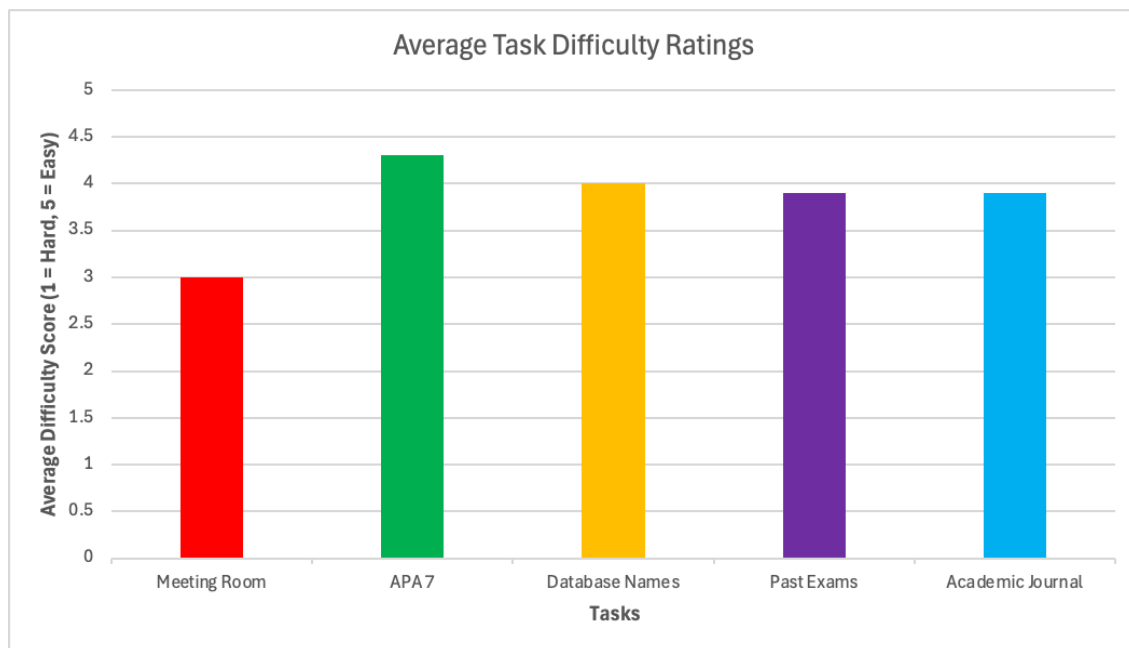


Figure 1

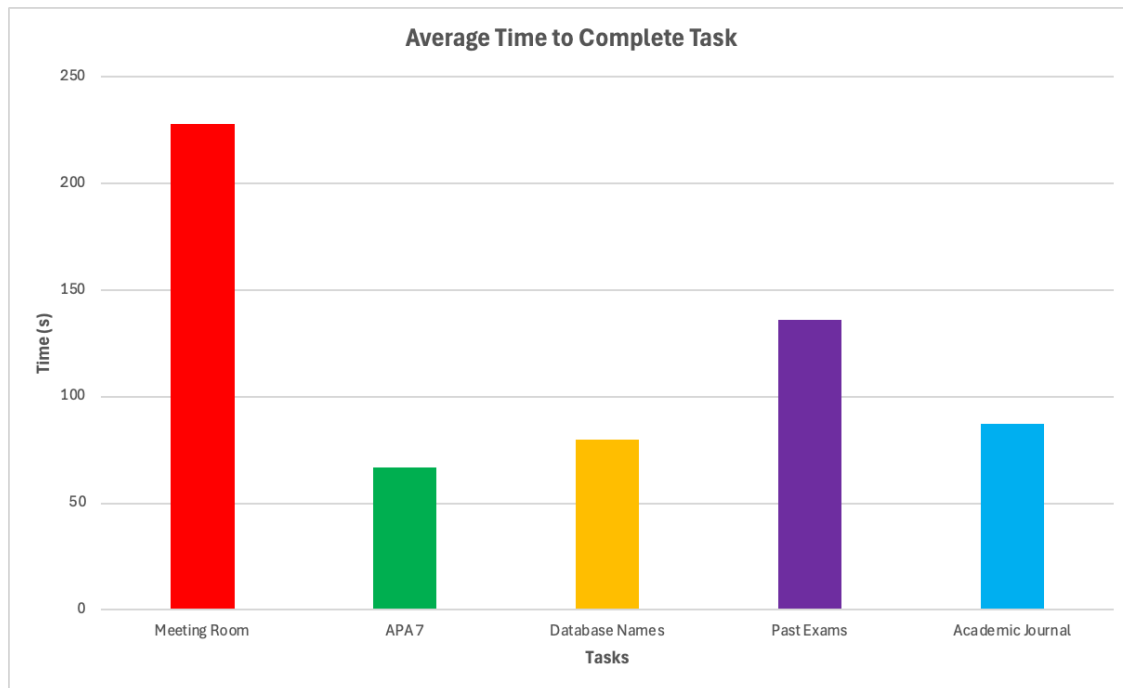


Figure 2

Note: One participant was unable to complete Task 1 which was to book a meeting room. The timer was stopped after 8 minutes and this data point was excluded from the average calculation as it was deemed an outlier.

According to Figure 1, it is clear that booking a meeting room was the hardest task while finding a guide on APA 7 was considered to be the easiest. This is further supported in Figure 2 where the task 'Meeting Room' took the longest time to complete while the task 'APA 7' took the shortest time.

This suggests there were several usability issues relating to Task 1 (Meeting Room). All participants were able to navigate to the correct page to book a room, however each participant followed a different path to get there suggesting that the navigation process lacks clarity and consistency. The process to actually reserve a space was where all participants struggled. There wasn't a clear procedure or guide and participants were overwhelmed with all the buttons and information present on the page. Most could not see the green 'add' icon when selecting a room and so they spent some time clicking on different things to try to figure out how to add the room to the 'Selected Spaces' section. After some time, participants managed to locate the 'add' icon and were able to book the room. However, there was one participant who was unable to locate this particular icon which led to them being unable to complete the task.

Task 2 (APA 7) was completed well. Once participants located the 'Re:cite' link, completing the task became straightforward. It was observed that some participants clicked on 'Library Guides' first but realised the resource was not there and so they went back.

Task 5 (Academic Journal) was also completed to a satisfactory standard as all participants knew how to locate the journal. The only minor issue detected was that the 'download' icon was hidden in plain sight and so it was not immediately obvious to participants.

The results for Task 3 (Database Names) were somewhat counter-intuitive. Although participants took less than 2 minutes on average to complete the task and reported that it was easy, their outcomes varied as participants arrived at different results. The majority could locate the 'Databases' heading near the search bar but some typed in 'Maths' while others typed in 'Mathematics' which led to slightly different results. One participant took a different route by clicking on 'Library Guides' followed by 'A-Z Databases.' They then searched up 'Mathematics' which again, displayed a different outcome compared to the other participants.

Several participants expressed that they were unsure if they had correctly completed Task 3. This demonstrates that while the task appears simple on the surface, the website does not provide sufficient feedback or confirmation during the database lookup processes. The lack of clear visual or textual cues may reduce users' confidence in the accuracy of their actions.

Task 4 (Past Exams) was straightforward. All participants were able to find past chemistry exams by typing in 'CHEM10003' in the search bar. However prior to this, most participants were seen looking around the website or going to various pages where they thought contained exams before finally deciding to use the search bar. This indicates that the path to past exams is not clearly visible or intuitively labeled within the site's structure. Additionally, participants typed in general keywords such as 'past exams' or 'chemistry' which led to no avail. This additional exploration and ineffective keyword use contributed to Task 4 having the second-longest average completion time according to Figure 2.

Only one participant avoided the home page search bar and instead managed to locate the 'Exam Papers' link after some exploration, thus accessing the exams through that navigation path. This particular link emphasizes how the Unimelb Library website has certain key features which are not prominent or easily discoverable.

Task 1

All five participants clearly struggled in the first task, with all of them finding it “confusing” to locate and book a study space in the DiBS software (*F1*). The participants all struggled with different areas of the DiBS software, revealing its lack of ease and poor design. Participant 2 encountered unexpected errors and was unable to complete the task, as they were not able to reserve their selected room. Participant 3 initially tried to book a room in the Bailieu library on the university website, but the DiBS software then reset this choice and the participant was made to choose again from a new list of places, hindering the participants progress of the task. Both participants 4 and 5 had the same issues of not being able to find in the software where to book a room and then reserve it, causing visible confusion and leading the participants to a trial and error method of completing the task (*F2*). Furthermore, participant 4 tried booking a “GSA”, not knowing that the acronym stood for Graduate Student Association, meaning the area the participant was trying to book was reserved for graduate students (*F3*). The facilitator had to intervene to inform the participant of this, presenting that important information that is directly relevant to the users is not displayed on the website.

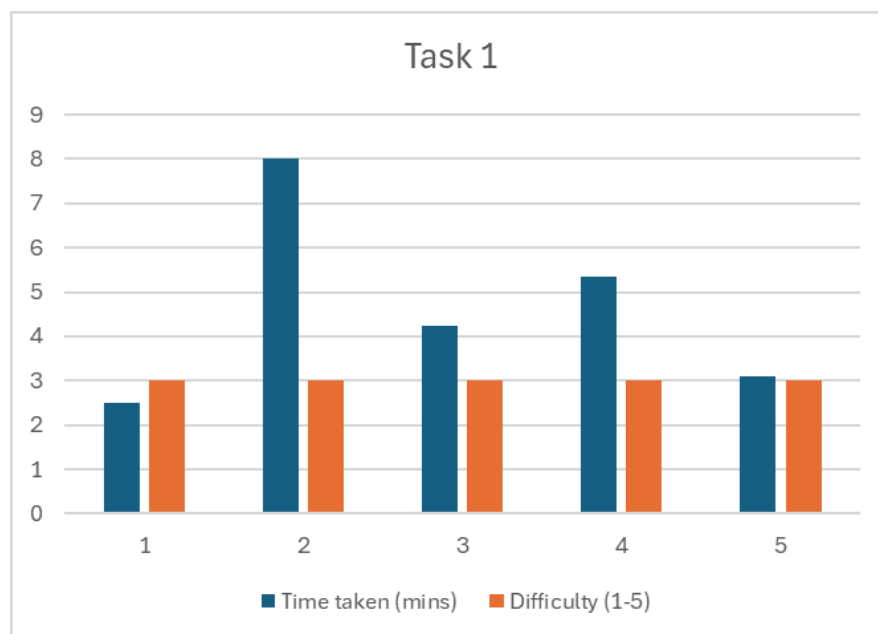


Figure 3

Figure 3 shows the time taken by each participant and their difficulty rating, where 1 is “very hard” and 5 is “very easy”. All participants are seen to agree on the difficulty of this task, giving it a 3, or “neutral”, making it the hardest task for the participants with an average rating of 3. More importantly, this graph shows the time taken to complete this task. Again, this task was seen to

be the hardest task, as on average it took the longest time to complete, with one participant being unable to complete it within 8 minutes, leading to intervention and termination of the task at that time point. These results show that all participants found this task confusing, in particular, they were unable to efficiently navigate the DiBS software to allocate a timeslot and make a reservation. For these reasons, the task of booking a study space was determined to be an inefficient and poorly designed process.

Task 2

The second task was completed successfully by all participants. Participants were able to complete this task through their cognitive ability to link “re:cite” with “recite” and referencing, thereby completing the task. Participants verbally mentioned locating “re:cite” and linking it to referencing. However, both participants 3 and 5 initially went into “library guides” from the home page. Since 2 out of 5 participants went into library guides initially, it suggests that some users may assume that referencing guides may appear within library guides (*F4*). Figure 4 shows the “Library guides” link highlighted in red and the “Re:cite” highlighted in green.

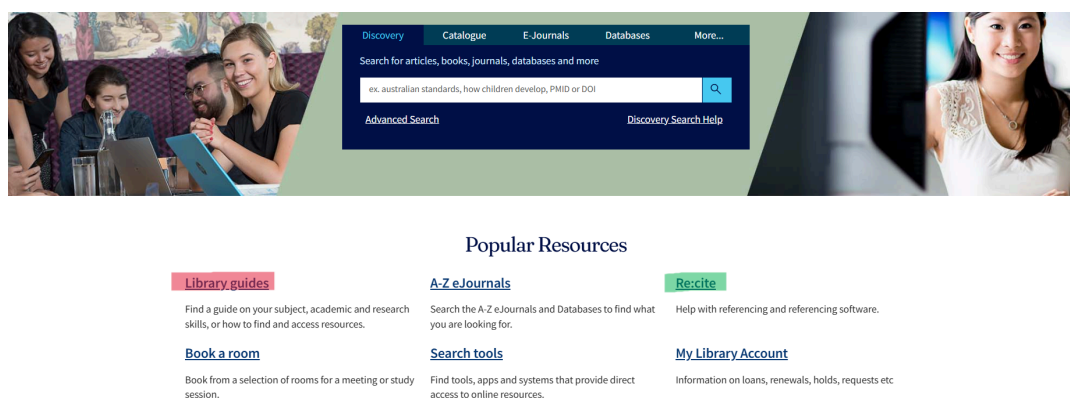


Figure 4



Figure 5

The figure 4 graph supports these findings, as this task had an average rating of 4.3/5, with the lowest ratings being 4. This proposes that the task was generally found to be easy among the participants. Additionally, since 3 out of the 5 participants completed the task within a minute, the results further indicate that this task was relatively easier compared to the other.

Task 3

The third test had a common theme among the participants, 4 out of 5 of the participants were unsure if they had found the required database, verbally stating they were “unsure”. Despite this confusion, all participants completed the task, even if most remained uncertain about whether they had found the correct database. (F5)

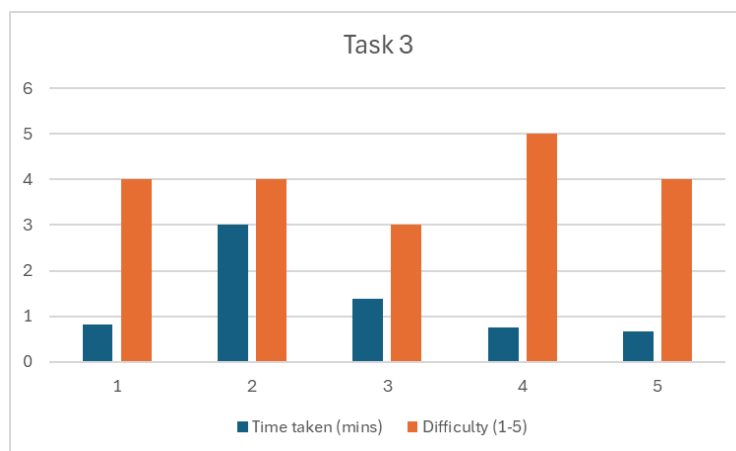


Figure 6

Figure 6 shows 3 out of 5 participants were able to complete the task in under a minute, suggesting the task is relatively easy, however participant 2 took 3 minutes to complete the same task, hinting that some users may have trouble locating and finding databases. Furthermore, the average difficulty was 4, which contrasts with the comments made by the participants when searching for the database. This indicates that while the participants did not find it difficult to search for databases and hence complete the task, they were still unconfident as to whether or not they had found the specific database they were looking for. Therefore this finding shows that while the process was found to be easy, interpreting the search results of the database is found to be confusing. (F6)

Task 4

Task 4 was completed successfully by users, however 3 out of 5 participants faced difficulties in locating where to search for past papers. Participant 1 was recorded navigating to a wrong page, retracing their steps back to the home page and examining the homepage for where to proceed with the task. Participant 2 and 5 also were confused as to where to search, with participant 2 going into library guides. Furthermore, search results were not always as the participants expected (F7), as participant 3 queried “Chemistry” but was unable to find chemistry exam papers, and participant 4 searched “past chemistry exams” but was met with VCE exams as seen in figure 7. Only upon searching “chem10003” were the papers shown.

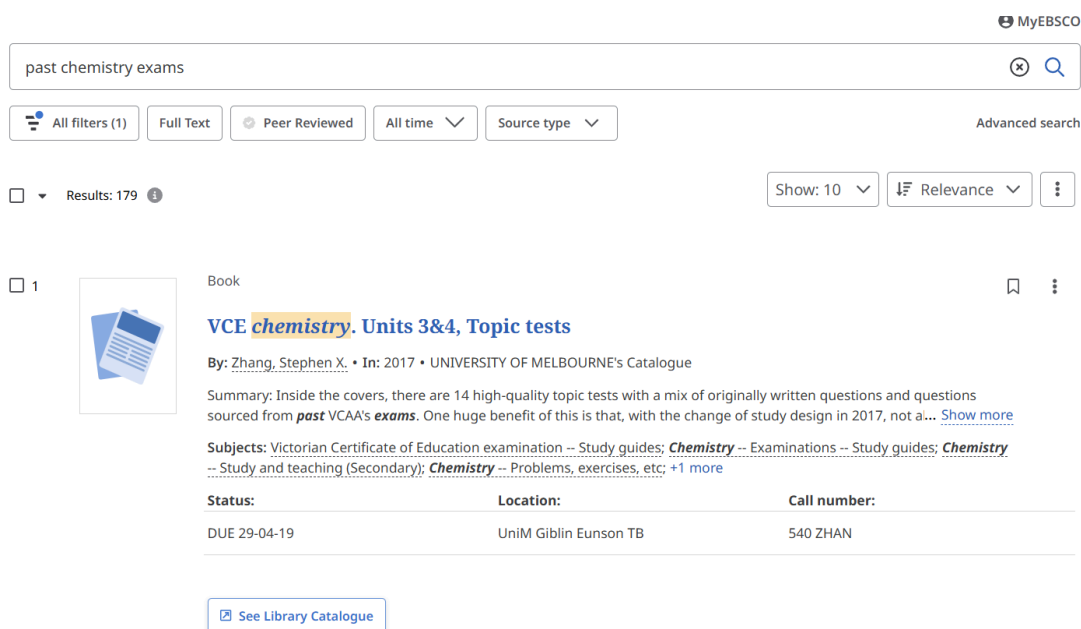


Figure 7

Despite these difficulties, the average difficulty score for this task was 3.9, with the lowest scores being 3s and the highest being a 5. This data, along with the participant's communication and screen recording presents that even though participants may have had minor issues in locating the past exams, they would not consider it detrimental to the website or navigation. This shows that while there are issues in locating past exams for a given subject and the process is not as streamlined as they would expect, the website is still functional and usable to a reasonable extent.

Task 5

All participants successfully completed the task with minimal difficulty. Their ability to intuitively use the search bar suggests that the feature is easily discoverable and supports efficient task completion. However after locating the academic journal, it was observed that the 'download' icon was not immediately obvious (F8). Some participants were seen scrolling down the page to look for it while others clicked on the 'Access Options' drop down list thinking that the download option was there.

Despite this, they were eventually able to find the small 'download' icon which was located at the top right corner of the page. This task demonstrated that some features such as the search bar are clearly visible while other features such as the 'download' icon lacked visibility and should be addressed.



Figure 8

Figure 8 shows an eye-tracking diagram generated from one of the participants. It can be observed that this participant initially did not notice the 'download' icon at all and most of the attention was focused on the content in the middle. This highlights how some icons are hidden in plain sight making it difficult to locate.

Debrief

Given that the Unimelb Library website offers a variety of resources and services, all participants stated that they would use the website again. This suggests that the usability of the site is adequate enough to facilitate high user retention.

On average, participants believed the overall website was **easy to use**. They also believed that the site had all the required functionalities to complete the task, suggesting the website has good **utility**. In general, participants were all satisfied with the amount of time it took to complete the tasks which indicates they were able to perform most of the tasks **efficiently**. This also insinuates the website has high **learnability** because participants could easily complete most tasks in a reasonable amount of time without needing any assistance or requiring strenuous cognitive effort. If participants were to visit the website again, most would remember how to do the tasks.

One issue that 2 out of the 5 participants verbally made clear was the sluggish feel of the website, as the participants' queries in the search bar would take an unexpectedly long time to process with no visual indicator that the query was being processed. Both participants expressed verbal concern regarding this issue and stated their dissatisfaction, and that the lack of any visual indicator caused confusion.

3 out of 5 participants felt confident using the website while the other 2 had neutral feelings. There were no explicit mentions of participants feeling unconfident when using the site which implies the site has a generally positive user experience. This is further reinforced by the fact that when asked to rate the level of agreement to the statement, "I thought the website had too many inconsistencies," most participants said they disagree. Similarly, participants generally disagree with the statement, "I found the website unnecessarily complex." However, it should be pointed out that there was one participant who did in fact agree to the previous two statements which highlights that although the website supports effective use for most users, there may be aspects of the interaction flow or design that may hinder usability for some individuals.

There were also mixed feelings with the statement, "I would imagine that most people would learn how to use this website very quickly," as some participants agreed with the statement while others disagreed. This implies the website may not be universally clear as some features or navigation may be obvious for certain users but confusing for others.

Statements	Average Rating <i>1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree</i>
I thought the website was easy to use	4
I found the website unnecessarily complex	2.8
I thought the website had too many inconsistencies	2.6
I felt confident using the website	3.6
I believe the website had all the required functionalities to complete the tasks	4.2
I would imagine that most people would learn how to use this website very quickly	3
If I visited the website again, I would remember how to do the tasks	4
I am satisfied with the amount of time it took to complete the tasks	4

Figure 9

5-Second Test

After viewing the home page for only five seconds, 71% of participants were able to correctly identify that University students are the ideal users for the Unimelb Library website. When asked, “What is the main thing you can recall?,” a variety of answers were given. 43% of participants remembered seeing images of “people smiling” while 21% of participants could recall that the website had several resources or “service sections” they could click on. Others noticed the “blue design” and could tell that the website belonged to the University of Melbourne. Additionally, 14% of participants correctly recognized that the website could be used to search for papers, articles and journals.

When asked, “What do you think you can do on this website?,” more than half of participants recognized that the website allows users to search for a variety of resources or find information “about the uni”. Furthermore, there were mixed opinions about the design of the site as some participants thought it was, “clear”, “functional”, “concise”, “practical”, “clean” and “minimalistic” while others thought it was, “messy”, “complicated” and “not good.”

The data collected suggests that upon first impressions, the Unimelb Library website is clear and intuitive as many participants were able to identify key features of the site and had a general understanding of its purpose.

Findings Summary

Findings Code	Task Number	Finding Quote
F1	1	"All five participants clearly struggled in the first task, with all of them finding it "confusing" to locate and book a study space in the DiBS software" (Page 12)
F2	1	"Both participants 4 and 5 had the same issues of not being able to find in the software where to book a room and then reserve it, causing visible confusion and leading the participants to a trial and error method of completing the task" (Page 12)
F3	1	"Participant 4 tried booking a "GSA", not knowing that the acronym stood for Graduate Student Association, meaning the area the participant was trying to book was reserved for graduate students" (Page 12)
F4	2	"Since 2 out of 5 participants went into library guides initially, it suggests that some users may assume that referencing guides may appear within library guides" (Page 13)
F5	3	"all participants completed the task, even if most remained uncertain about whether they had found the correct database" (Page 14)
F6	3	"while the process was found to be easy, interpreting the search results of the database is found to be confusing" (Page 14)
F7	4	"search results were not always as the participants expected" (Page 15)
F8	5	"However after locating the academic journal, it was observed that the 'download' icon was not immediately obvious" (Page 16)

Recommendations

Limitations of Method and Results

- Small sample size consisting primarily of students from Computer Science (in BSci or BDes) backgrounds, leading to an identifiable pattern but not statistically generalizable
- As participants were students from the University Of Melbourne, participants were somewhat familiar or had at least some previous experience of interacting with the library website or a similar website within the University Of Melbourne which likely made completing the tasks easier for them.
- Requesting participants to "think aloud" may have slowed down their navigation process

- Tasks focused on common and everyday student activities which may not test the edge cases where the website's problems, that had not been identified previously, may occur.

Recommendation Justifications

R1: Guide users through the booking process step by step with the progress header

Linked Finding: *F1*

Justification: All participants describe the flow as confusing, with issues at different points. Guiding users step by step reduces confusion and ensures that the user understands the steps they need to take to book the room in the correct order. Only allow the user to move to the next section when they have completed the task properly.



*Figure 10-11: Heatmaps of Task 1
(Book a meeting room for next Thursday at 2pm)*

R2: Make the “Create Reservation” button appear in a more noticeable location only when it is applicable

Linked Finding: *F1, F2*

Justification: P4 and P5 could not find where to start the booking and switched to trial and error. Making the button more noticeable helps users find where to start their booking. In addition, participants would prematurely press the button leading to more confusion.

R3: Show clear error messages for ineligible booking spaces

Linked Finding: *F1, F3*

Justification: P4 tried booking 'GSA' without knowing it's for graduate students. Blocking ineligible bookings will reduce failed attempts and confusion.

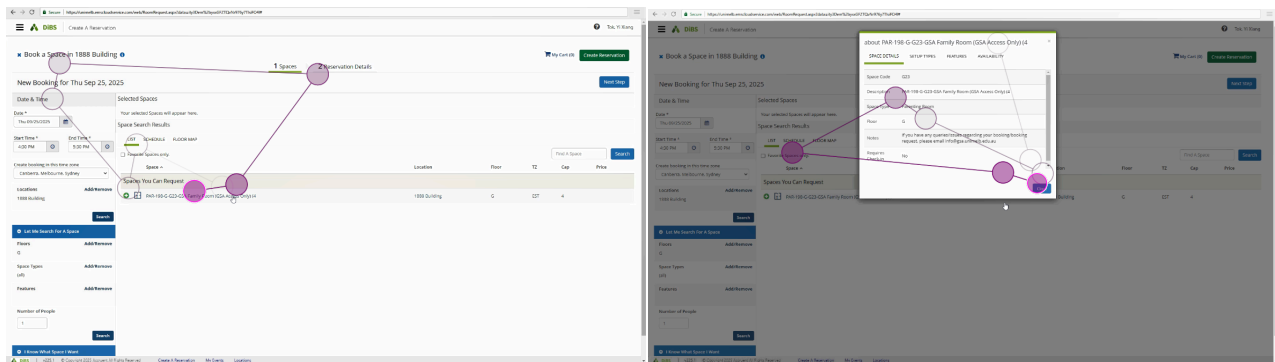


Figure 12-13: ‘GSA’ stands for Graduate Student Association, meaning the area the participant was trying to book was reserved for graduate students.

R4: Rename “Re:cite” to “Referencing and Citations.”

Linked Finding: F4

Justification: When looking for referencing help, P3 and P5 went to Library guides instead of re:cite, indicating the current labels do not guide all users to the right place. “Referencing and citations” is more understandable and reduces misnavigation from the home page.

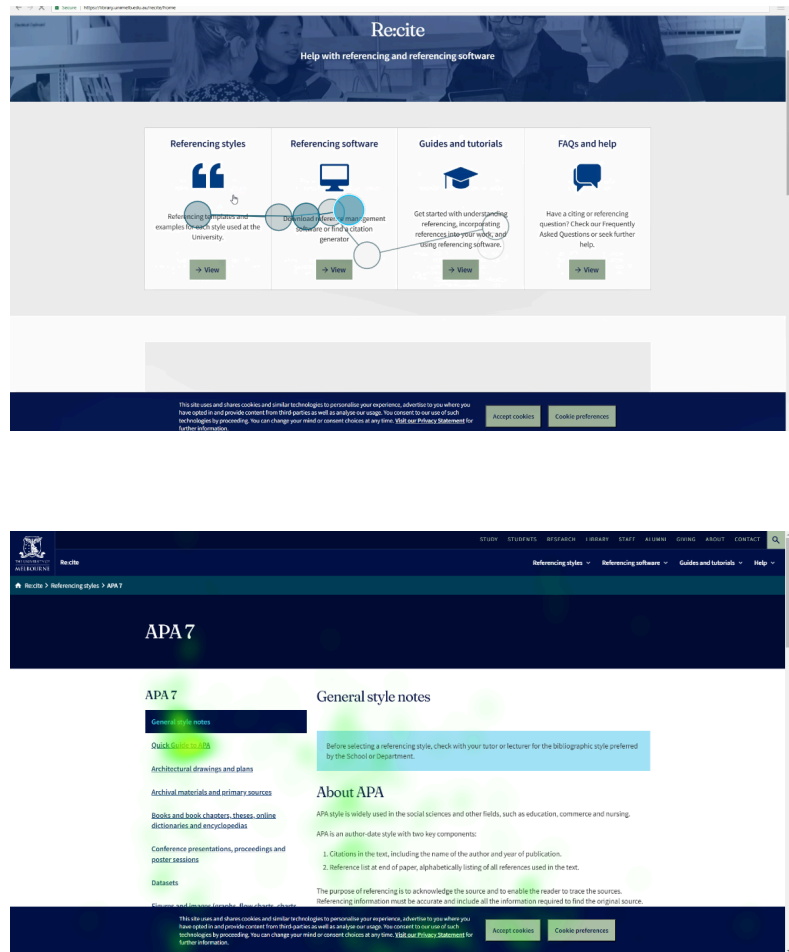
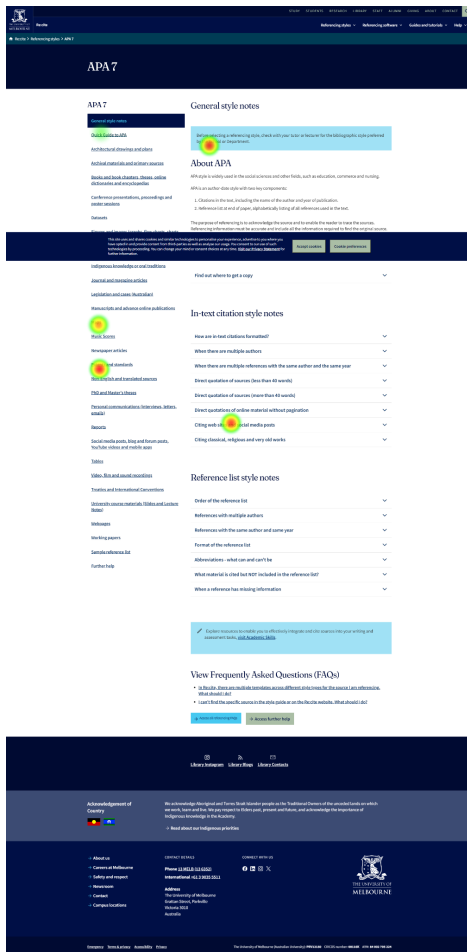
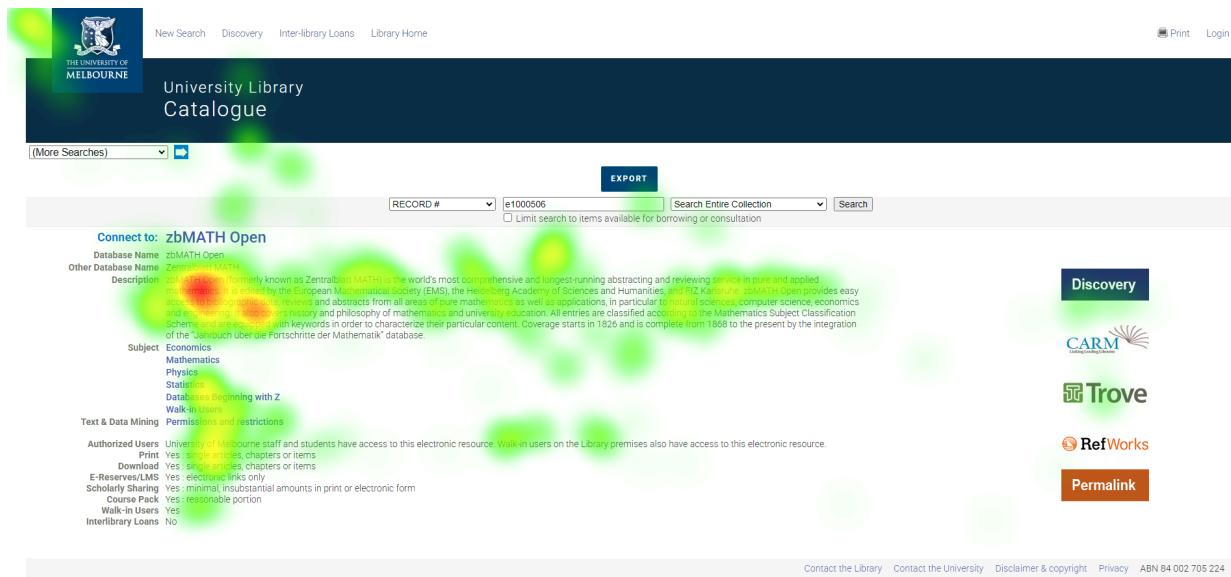


Figure 14-16: Saccades and the AOIs of P3 and P5 when they were trying to look for “Referencing and Citations”

R5: Add confirmation text like “Matched to: Mathematics.” to search bar results

Linked Finding: F5, F6

Justification: Participants lacked confirmation that they’d found the right database on partial queries. Ranking subjects matches first and displaying a small “Matched to: Mathematics” message on the result and database page will signal relevance and ensure user’s queries are matched to the correct databases.



*Figure 17: Heatmaps of Task 3
(Identify the names of databases used in Mathematics)*

R6: Make the “All Filters” button more prominent and easier to find

Linked Finding: F7

Justification: Users were unsure how to find past papers and opted to use the search bar, missing the filter that would help their search. Making the filter button more visible will signal it is available and encourage use.

R7: Make functions more noticeable by increasing their size or labeling icons with their functions, e.g “Download PDF”

Linked Finding: F8

Justification: When trying to download the journal entry, participants overlooked the small download icon. A labeled and consistently placed button improves user's recognition over testing their ability to recall.

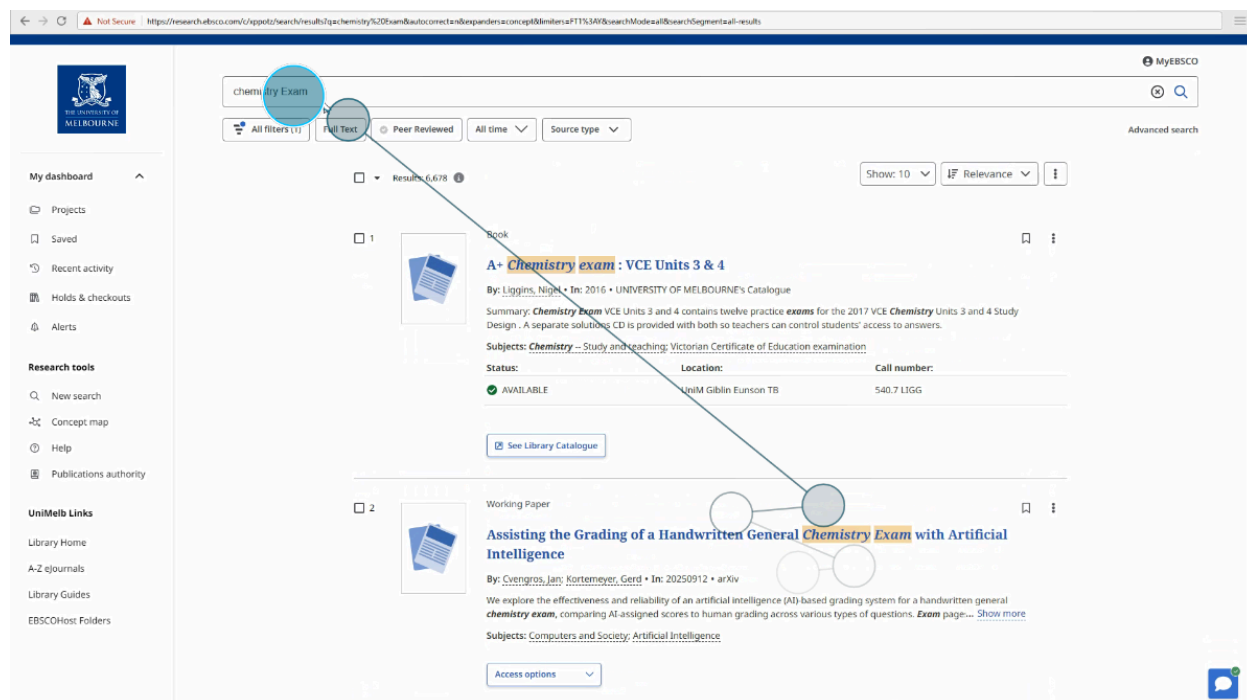


Figure 18: Consider adding a small download icon to clearly indicate downloadable Journal Articles and Online Databases on the website.

R8: Replace the green 'add' icon with a green 'Select Space' button in the 'Book a Space in a Library' page

Linked Finding: *F1*

Justification: Most participants did not notice the green 'add' icon when trying to select a space. Adding a 'Select Space' button would make it more clear for users.

Recommendations Summary Table

Ref. Number	Linked Finding	Recommendation	Stage	User Priority	Actions	Accepted
R1	F1	Guide users through the booking process step by step with the progress header	1	High	Note for Design & Front end	
R2	F1, F2	Make the "Create Reservation" button appear in a more noticeable location only when it is applicable	1	High	Note for Design	
R3	F1, F3	Show clear error messages for ineligible bookings spaces	1	Moderate	Note for Content & Front end	
R4	F4	Rename "Re:Cite" to "Referencing and Citations"	2	Moderate	Note for Content & Design	
R5	F5, F6	Add confirmation text like "Matched to: Mathematics." to search bar results	1	Moderate	Note for Search & Front end	
R6	F7	Make the "All Filters" button more prominent and easier to find	2	Moderate	Note for Design and Front End	
R7	F8	Make functions more noticeable by increasing their size or labeling icons with their functions, e.g "Download PDF"	1	High	Note for Design & Front end	
R8	F1	Replace the green 'add' icon with a green 'Select Space' button in the 'Book a Space in a Library' page	1	High	Note for Design	

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Appendices

AI Declaration

We declare that no AI was used throughout the course of this assignment. All work and information came from the expertise of university UX students as well as sources from websites that have been appropriately referenced.

ID	Full Name	Signature	Date
1617157	Revant Srivastava	R.S.	25/10/2025
1605617	Stephen Ly	S.L.	25/10/2025
1296417	Proud Tanamartyarat	P.T.	25/10/2025
1658010	Yi Xiang David Tok	Y.X	25/10/2025
1499905	Bowen Mai	B.M	25/10/2025

Appendix 1

Data Collection Template

Participant No.

Note: The facilitator will fill in the table for each participant

Task	Overall Difficulty (Out of 5)	Time	Observations
Meeting Room			
Find APA7			
Database Names			
Past Exams			
Download PDF			

Debrief Notes

Note: Participants will fill in this table at the very end

Type 'X' in one of the boxes for each statement

Statements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
I thought the website was easy to use					
I found the website unnecessarily complex					
I thought the website had too many inconsistencies					
I felt confident using the website					
I believe the website had all the required functionalities to complete the tasks					
I would imagine that most people would learn to this website very quickly					
If I visited the website again, I would remember how to do the tasks					
I am satisfied with the amount of time it took to complete the tasks					

Test Protocol

1. Introduction Script:

One-on-One User Testing

Note: Testing should be done in a quiet room/area

“Hello and welcome, my name is [facilitator name].

My team and I are currently working on an assignment that involves evaluating the usability of the [Unimelb Library Website](#). To do this, we need to get some user feedback and this is where you come in.

I have a list of tasks that I would like you to complete on the website and for each task please try to explain what you are doing out loud as you go. Let me know when you finish.

For analysis purposes, you will be **recorded** and we will also be **observing** you and **taking down notes**. We will also track your eye movements using an **eye tracking device**. For each task, we will **time you** to see how long it takes but please do not feel pressured or overwhelmed. You can complete the task at a pace you are most comfortable with, and you can ask questions as you go.

We are not testing you; we are just testing the website, so don't stress if you are unable to complete the task. If you are stuck, just let me know and I can help.

This session should take about 25 minutes of your time, and all information collected is kept anonymous and is not communicated in any form to people not involved in this project. You can also choose to leave at any time if you are feeling uncomfortable, need a break or simply do not wish to continue participating in this test.

Do you have any questions?”

2. Consent Form:

"I have been informed about the study and understand that all information collected will be strictly confidential. I understand that I will be recorded for the purposes of documentation and analysis related to this study. I recognize that my participation in this study is entirely voluntary, and I am free to withdraw at any time without consequence.

I agree to participate in this study and give my consent to the collection, use and analysis of my data for research purposes."

Full Name:

Date:

Signature:

3. Participant Profile:

Note: Each participant will fill in the table below

Name:	
Age:	
What degree are you currently studying?	
Australian Citizen:	YES / NO (circle one)
University of Melbourne Student:	YES / NO (circle one)

How confident are you with using the Unimelb Library Website? (Tick One)

Very Unconfident	Unconfident	Neutral	Confident	Very Confident

4. Pre – Questions:

Allows participants exactly one minute to view, explore and play around with the website.

Ask participants these questions

- Have you used this system before?
- What are your first impressions?
- Does this look like the sort of app you would use?

5. Perform Usability Test:

Note: Refer to the 'Data Collection Template' Section

Ask participants to complete the following tasks:

- Book a meeting room for next Thursday at 2pm
- Find a guide on how to style APA 7
- Identify the names of databases used in Mathematics
- Find past exams for chemistry (CHEM10003)
- Download a copy of the academic journal titled, "One More Time, Does Money Buy Happiness" by Fisher, James.

For each task, observe the users. Take note of what they are doing and any issues encountered. Remind them to talk aloud. Additionally, time and record how long it takes for participants to complete each task. Timer should begin when users click on a button and end when users alert the facilitator that they are done with the task.

Ask them the following questions:

"What are you trying to do now?"

"Are you looking for something specific?"

"Is there something missing that would help you to complete the task?"

IMPORTANT: At the end of EACH task, ask participants to rate the overall difficulty of the task with a number between 1 and 5. The higher the number, the easier the task.

6. Debrief:

Note: Refer to the 'Data Collection Template' Section

Ask participants the following questions:

Overall, how easy or difficult was it to use this website?

Do you think you would use this website yourself? Why / Why not?

Is there anything you would like to add?

Ask participants to rate the following statements between 1 and 5:

Note (1 = Strongly disagree, 5 = Strongly agree)

- I thought the website was easy to use
- I found the website unnecessarily complex
- I thought the website had too many inconsistencies
- I felt confident using the website
- I believe the website had all the required functionalities to complete the tasks
- I would imagine that most people would learn to this website very quickly
- If I visited the website again, I would remember how to do the tasks
- I am satisfied with the amount of time it took to complete the tasks

7. Conclusion:

"That concludes the study. Thank you so much for participating. Your feedback is very helpful and will play an important role in improving the website. Do you have any further questions?"

Side Note: Generally, participants should be compensated with money for participating, but due to the study being in a university setting, we are unable to pay participants. Instead, participants could be offered a small snack like chocolate or candy (if possible).

Appendix 2: Final Report on Choice Community

Analysis of Interview Results

Overall, the participants' behaviors provided insight into both strengths and weaknesses of CHOICE Community's usability. A recurring theme across tasks was entry discoverability. Participants A and C had difficulty locating the sign-up option, rating it as non-intuitive. In contrast, Participant B identified it quickly, suggesting that prior experience with forums may help users overcome design shortcomings.

Form clarity and password rules were another issue. Three participants (A,B,C) noted that instructions for creating a password were unclear until an error occurred, undermining efficiency. Similarly, error messages were vague, leading to repeated failed attempts in **Task 1**. These difficulties support earlier heuristic findings about inadequate system feedback and error prevention. (*see Raw Data: Interview Results*)

When completing **Task 2 (creating a new post)**, participants diverged in their confidence levels. Participant B praised the editor's simplicity, while Participants A and C found it lacking guidance, particularly regarding categories and tags. Participant D noted that the absence of a clear preview created uncertainty before publishing. This reinforced that while the posting function works for experienced users, it fails to support novices adequately. However, a particular concerning incident occurred with Participant A during this task. After attempting to register, he received a hostile automated message labelling him an "Indian spammer."

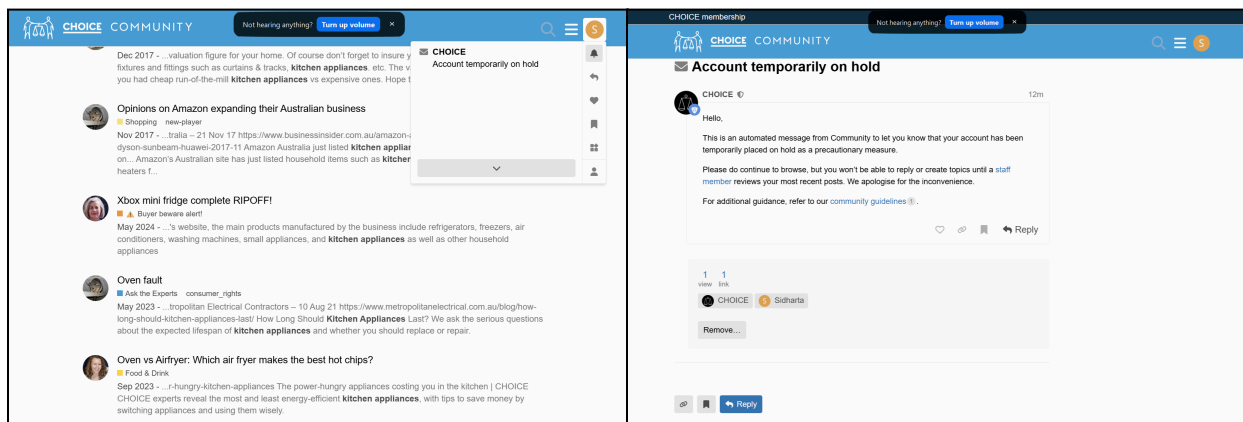


Figure 21-22: Participant's A account got a 'temporarily hold' message

Not only was this incorrect—Participant A is not Indian—but it revealed a discriminatory and unprofessional element in the system's onboarding workflow. The experience was described by the participant as "rude and racist," leaving them reluctant to continue exploring the platform. This behavior highlights a critical usability and ethical flaw: first-time users should never be

disrespected, alienated, or mischaracterized by a platform they are considering joining. As Barnum (2020) emphasizes, trust and respect are fundamental to user adoption, and Rubin & Chisnell (2008) note that entry discoverability should be accompanied by welcoming feedback, not hostile rejection. In this case, Choice Community's design and moderation systems failed to support inclusivity, actively undermining the onboarding process. Addressing this issue is not only a matter of usability but of equity, respect, and community values. ([see Raw Data: Interview Results of Participant A on Task 2 Step 8 Post-publish reflection](#))

Task 3 (finding a discussion on kitchen appliances) produced mixed results. Participant B used the search bar successfully, but others struggled with category clarity and info scent. Participant C spent several minutes scanning unrelated discussions before abandoning the task. This highlighted inconsistencies in search quality and discoverability of content.

In **Task 4 (replying to a discussion)**, all participants managed to post, but several expressed uncertainty about whether their reply had been directed correctly. Participant D highlighted the lack of strong visual cues for quoting, while Participant A expected a more obvious confirmation after posting. These observations underscore weaknesses in system feedback and contextual clarity.

Task 5 (flagging an inappropriate comment) revealed significant concerns. While all participants eventually located the report option, most described the process as unintuitive. Participants A and C were unsure about anonymity, while Participant B questioned whether reports would be acted upon. Participants emphasized the lack of visible confirmation or progress indicators, reducing trust in the reporting system.

Raw Data: Interview Results

Participant A

Name: Sid

Age: 19

Gender: Male

Country of Birth: Indonesia

Australian Citizen: YES / **NO**

Question	Response Options
----------	------------------

What operating system do you use most often?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Laptop, Phones, Tablet
What web browser do you normally use?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Chrome
Do you currently use any social media platforms?	☒ Yes / No
How often do you use social media?	☒ Daily
	☐ Weekly
	☐ Monthly
	☐ Rarely
	☐ Never
Which social media platforms do you use most frequently?	☒ Instagram
	☐ Facebook
	☐ Twitter (X)
	☐ Reddit
	☒ Other(s): YouTube
How many hours per week do you typically spend on social media?	☐ Less than 1 hour - 1 hour
	☐ 1 hour
	☐ 2-3 hours (a couple of hours)
	☐ 4-6 hours (a few hours)
	☒ 9+ hours
Do you prefer using social media on mobile or desktop?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Mobile
What are your main reasons for using social media? (e.g., socialising, news, work, community)	<u>Comment(s):</u> Socializing with friends and family

Have you ever used a decentralised social platform before (e.g., Mastodon, PeerTube, Lemmy)?	☒ Yes / No I have no idea what that is
On a scale of 1–5, how comfortable do you feel trying new social platforms?	☐ 1
	☐ 2
☐ 1 = not comfortable and 5 = comfortable	☐ 3
	☐ 4
	☒ 5

TASK 1: Sign up as a new user

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) Locate “Sign Up” option on homepage	“Imagine you are visiting the CHOICE Community for the first time and want to join the platform. Please show me how you would start the registration process.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): 1) IP Address (cannot use UNIMELB WIFI to sign-up), 2) Quite standard and familiar in terms of where to find the sign-up page, however there was an IP issue that didn't allow registration. Hence, we had to switch to our hotspots which is a bit of an inconvenience).					
2) Form clarity	“Now that you have opened the sign-up page, what are your first impressions of the form? Is it clear what information you need to provide?” (NOTE: Field labels & placeholders were clear?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The prompts were all very clear and quite well labelled, the structure as well was quite familiar starting with email, then username, then password.					

3) Password rules	“Before you enter a password, take a look at the password requirements. Are they clear to you? Please describe what you expect the rules to be.” (NOTE: Password requirements were visible & understandable?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): To be honest, I wasn't really aware of the requirements until I started typing. I think it would be better if the requirements were written before you enter anything. Otherwise, it may feel a bit annoying having to edit and re-edit.					
4) Enter password	“Please create a password for your new account. Tell me what you are thinking as you enter it.” If there is an ERROR , does it tell you how to fix it?	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It's good in terms that it shows you which part is missing instead of just an error prompt.					
5) Submit form with missing/invalid info	“Imagine you accidentally skipped a required field. Please submit the form and see what happens. After knowing this, I knew what would happen next (e.g., email verify)”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
6) Wait for confirmation	“Now that you have submitted the form, what do you expect will happen next? Please describe what feedback you see on the screen. I felt comfortable sharing info here.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It's good that it brought me back to the homepage that I saw previously before signing up, however the big bunch of text kind of makes it a little bit daunting.					
7) Review privacy statement	“Before finalizing your account, please check if you can find any information about privacy or how your data will	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	be used. What are your impressions? (E.g., Signing up felt quick, not too many steps/clicks)."	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Yes, I was able to identify the privacy statements, but it was quite small that I had to double check. Without knowing I have agreed with these statements. I think if there was just a checkbox to let me know during that I've agreed, then that would be great.					
8) Evaluate entire process	"Now that you have completed the sign-up steps, how would you describe the overall process? Was it easy, confusing, or time-consuming? Please explain to the interviewer or leave a comment."	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): In my opinion, it's good in the terms that it was quite familiar to me in terms of the sign-up page, everything is quite organized and clear. However, the IP issue was a bit of a bother to me to x and some requirements were popping in and out.					

TASK 2: Create a new post asking for advice (Repeat at the End)

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) CTA discoverability	"Imagine you want to ask the community for advice. How would you start creating a new post? Please show me where you would begin. Is the New Topic/Post button being easy to find."	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): In my opinion, in terms of placement the New Topic button is new, but the font being the same size with the other text makes it kind of blend in with the tabs which can take a minute for me to find. I think a greyed-out background does help, but it could be more effective with other colours.					
2) Category choice	"Now that you're creating a post, how do you decide	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	which category to place it in? Please describe your thought process.”	Rating	1	2	3	4	5	Comment(s): I think in terms of post categories, it's good that it was quite diverse. But, I had to search up a broad topic like “design” while there were more less relevant “topics” being shown featured wise. Some categories were also a bit questionable like “Ruby’s corner”. I reckon I will try organizing main topics to be in the more featured categories.
3) Tagging	“Do you see an option to add tags to your post? What tags would you add, and how easy or difficult is it to understand how tagging works here?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	Rating 1 2 3 4 5 Comment(s): I think the tags are a cool feature to have, however the names were overlapping with the main category which kind of confused me on what makes them different in the first place. I think a better method is to make the “general” more generic topics, while tags can be more focused.
4) Editor usability	“Please type your question into the editor. As you do this, what do you notice about the editor’s features? Is it clear how to format or structure your message?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	Rating 1 2 3 4 5 Comment(s): It is clear in the formatting like one sentence, however, if there was an example to follow it would make it clearer.
5) Preview / feedback	“Before posting, do you see any way to preview how your message will look? If so, how useful is the preview? If not, what would you expect to see?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	Rating 1 2 3 4 5 Comment(s): I think the preview is fairly clean and not confusing to utilize. When I post it also looks the same way as it does. Though the lack

		of a clear box makes it confusing where the post actually starts and niches.					
6) Save/validation	“Imagine you’ve written your post but accidentally left a field blank. What happens if you try to save or post it? Is the feedback clear?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It’s quite clear in terms of where I’m supposed to write and fill up with the required amount of text.					
7) Confidence to publish	“Looking at your post now, how confident do you feel about publishing it? Do you feel ready to share it with the community, or are you uncertain?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): In terms of publishing confidence, I do feel good with the fact that there is a clear sense of community going on with the amount of posts. However, the homepage being filled with random discussions makes it kind of daunting on whether your question sounds stupid.					
8) Post-publish reflection	“Now that you’ve published your post, how do you know it worked? What feedback do you see that tells you the post is live and visible to others?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It’s good that it takes me to my post page and I can clearly see the title, my name, and my text in it. So overall it’s quite clear. But then, I got BANNED by a moderator without my notice and without clear reasoning. Very unprofessional BAN message being RACIST and UNCLEAR towards me. (NOTE: The participant would like to give a rating of less than 1 = ZERO for this category)					

TASK 3: Find a discussion about kitchen appliances

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) Findability	“Imagine you want to read what people are saying about kitchen appliances. Where would you go first on this site to start looking?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I went to the search bar first thinking that it would be there and it did show the topics that had the keyword.					
2) Info scent	“As you look at the available links, categories, or headings, what makes you think one of these will lead to kitchen appliance discussions?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): As they had the Kitchen Appliance keyword in the prompt.					
3) Search quality	“Please try using the search function to look for ‘kitchen appliances.’ How do the results compare with what you expected?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I mean considering the generic prompt of kitchen appliances, I was shocked that there were only 2 prompts that directly relate to kitchen appliances. Though understandably so...					
4) Filters/sort	“If you want to narrow the results, what filters or sorting options do you see? How helpful are they in finding the right discussion?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The filters that they used are quite unclear and confusing to understand as they are very generic and non-descriptive. “I read”, “I liked”.					

5) Category clarity	“Do the site’s categories make sense for finding a topic like kitchen appliances? Which one seems the best fit, and why?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The categories are good in the fact that it’s quite diverse in topics. However, this goes without saying that the topics are a bit too diverse that simple topics become a challenge to find.					
6) Tag clarity	“Do any tags stand out as helpful for this kind of topic? Are the tags clear enough to guide you to the right posts?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The topics are quite diverse but, the fact that I can’t scroll down and instead have to search it and it doesn’t even exist. This becomes quite confusing to navigate through.					
7) Page scanning	“Now that you’re on the results or category page, how easy is it to scan and identify a relevant discussion about kitchen appliances?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It’s quite clear in terms of how it prompts me with the topics that have the “kitchen appliance” keywords in it.					
8) Outcome utility	“Looking at the discussion you found, does it give you the kind of information you were hoping for? Why or why not?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Considering the social aspect of the webpage not being that lively. Certain topics were just sad and not talked about. Considering the Kitchen Appliance topic being quite generic, the fact that it’s not talked about is quite depressing.					

TASK 4: Reply to a thread **I GOT BANNED :(**

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
9) CTA discoverability	“Imagine you’ve read a post in a discussion and want to reply. What do you see on the page that suggests how to start your reply?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
10) Target clarity	“As you begin replying, how clear is it who or what your reply will be directed to? Do you feel confident your response is going to the right place?” (NOTE: I could clearly tell who I was replying to)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
11) On-screen cues	“What cues do you notice on the screen that confirm you are in reply mode? Are these cues strong enough to reassure you?” (NOTE: The UI showed clear cues like).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
12) Context/quoting	“If you wanted to quote part of the original post for context, how would you do that? Is this option visible and clear?” (NOTE: It was clear how to quote or include context from the thread if needed).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					

13) Editor usability	“Please type your reply into the editor. How does the writing experience feel to you? Is formatting or adding content intuitive?” (NOTE: The editor made it easy to type)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
14) Preview / placement	“Before submitting, do you see any way to preview how your reply will look? Do you know where it will appear in the thread?” (NOTE: I could preview or understand where my reply would appear in the thread).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
15) Mentions / tagging	“If you wanted to mention another user in your reply, how would you do that? How easy or difficult does it seem?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
16) System feedback	“After posting your reply, what feedback do you see that tells you it was successful? How confident are you that others can now see your reply?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					

TASK 5: Flag an inappropriate comment I GOT BANNED :(

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)
----------------------	------------------------	--

17) Entry discoverability	“Imagine you’ve just seen a comment that you think breaks the community rules. What would you do first to flag or report it?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
18) Reason	“When you try to report the comment, how clear are the options for explaining why you are flagging it? Do they match your expectations?” (NOTE: The report’s reasons were clear and fit my situation).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
19) Guidance / policy	“Do you see any guidance about what counts as inappropriate content? How would that affect your decision to report this comment?” (NOTE: Any brief guidance/policy hints helped me decide whether to report).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
20) Effort	“How much effort does it feel like to complete this reporting process? Does it seem quick and simple, or more complicated than you expected?” (NOTE: Reporting felt quick and straightforward).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
21) Anonymity & trust	“Do you feel confident that your report will stay anonymous? How much do you trust the system to handle your report fairly?” (NOTE: I felt	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

	safe/anonymous reporting this comment).	Comment(s):					
22) Confirmation	“After submitting your report, what feedback do you get? How do you know your report went through?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
23) Reversibility	“If you realized you reported by mistake, how would you undo it? Do you see an option for cancelling or reversing the action?” (NOTE: It was clear how to undo/cancel if I changed my mind)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					
24) Expected outcome	“What do you expect will happen next with the report you just made? Do you think you’ll be updated, and how soon?” (NOTE: I understand what happens next)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s):					

Post-Test Questions

Task	Overall Difficulty (Out of 5)	Time	Comments
1	3	15 minuets	
2	3-4	20 minuets	
3	2-3	Around 10-15 minuets	
4	-	-	

5	-	-	
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Participant B

Name: Kevin

Age: 21

Gender: Male

Country of Birth: New Zealand

Australian Citizen: **YES** / NO

Question	Response Options
What operating system do you use most often?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Windows
What web browser do you normally use?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Firefox
Do you currently use any social media platforms?	☒ Yes / No
How often do you use social media?	☒ Daily
	☐ Weekly
	☐ Monthly
	☐ Rarely
	☐ Never
Which social media platforms do you use most frequently?	☒ Instagram
	☐ Facebook
	☒ Twitter (X)
	☐ Reddit

	☒ Other(s): YouTube, Discord
How many hours per week do you typically spend on social media?	☐ Less than 1 hour - 1 hour
	☐ 1 hour
	☐ 2-3 hours (a couple of hours)
	☐ 4-6 hours (a few hours)
	☒ 9+ hours
Do you prefer using social media on mobile or desktop?	Comment(s): Mobile
What are your main reasons for using social media? (e.g., socialising, news, work, community)	Comment(s): Socializing with friends and family; community engagement.
Have you ever used a decentralised social platform before (e.g., Mastodon, PeerTube, Lemmy)?	☒ Yes / No I have no idea what that is
On a scale of 1–5, how comfortable do you feel trying new social platforms? ☒ 1 = not comfortable and 5 = comfortable	☐ 1
	☐ 2
	☐ 3
	☒ 4
	☐ 5

TASK 1: Sign up as a new user

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) Locate “Sign Up” option on homepage	“Imagine you are visiting the CHOICE Community for the first time and want to join the platform. Please show me how you would start the registration process.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): IP issue was annoying. The big green button saying Join Community made things easy to navigate.					
2) Form clarity	“Now that you have opened the sign-up page, what are your first impressions of the form? Is it clear what information you need to provide?” (NOTE: Field labels & placeholders were clear?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): No notes very simple and easy to understand :)					
3) Password rules	“Before you enter a password, take a look at the password requirements. Are they clear to you? Please describe what you expect the rules to be.” (NOTE: Password requirements were visible & understandable?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The requirements did not show up immediately and only once you started typing your PW in.					
4) Enter password	“Please create a password for your new account. Tell me what you are thinking as you enter it.” If there is an ERROR , does it tell you how to fix it?	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was unsure of what the actual password requirements were as it only reveals the missing requirements as you type it in, so I wasn't sure if I was typing in a valid password.					
5) Submit form with missing/invalid info	“Imagine you accidentally skipped a required field. Please submit the form and see what happens. After knowing this, I knew what would happen next (e.g., email verify)”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The form gives good instructions when you miss information and tells you what happens next, for example it tells you that they will send an email confirmation.					

6) Wait for confirmation	“Now that you have submitted the form, what do you expect will happen next? Please describe what feedback you see on the screen. I felt comfortable sharing info here.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I expected an email confirmation to be sent to me, and the screen also told me that as well, it also gave the option to resend the confirmation email which is nice. I was comfortable sharing info.					
7) Review privacy statement	“Before finalizing your account, please check if you can find any information about privacy or how your data will be used. What are your impressions? (E.g., Signing up felt quick, not too many steps/clicks).”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was able to find information on privacy and data usage easily at the bottom of the page, although the text is small. Signing up itself was quick and didn't require much effort.					
8) Evaluate entire process	“Now that you have completed the sign-up steps, how would you describe the overall process? Was it easy, confusing, or time-consuming? Please explain to the interviewer or leave a comment.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Very simple and straightforward. It wasn't confusing or time consuming at all. The interface was very simple and clearly communicated what I needed, but the password requirements not being all present was annoying.					

TASK 2: Create a new post asking for advice (Repeat at the End)

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) CTA discoverability	“Imagine you want to ask the community for advice. How would you start creating a	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	new post? Please show me where you would begin. Is the New Topic/Post button easy to find?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5	Comment(s): I would try to find a button that includes the phrase "New ____". It was fairly simple to find the New Topic button but the colour and size made it a bit more obscured than it should be. It was a bit small and was grey over a white background.
2) Category choice	"Now that you're creating a post, how do you decide which category to place it in? Please describe your thought process."	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	Comment(s): It was helpful that each category gave a short description of the sort of stuff that would fall under it, so it helped me narrow down the category of my post. My thought process was that I saw a text box called General and I clicked it assuming it would be a drop down menu or text box to input the category.
3) Tagging	"Do you see an option to add tags to your post? What tags would you add, and how easy or difficult is it to understand how tagging works here?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	Comment(s): It is easy to add in tags for my post, although I'm not entirely sure what the purpose of tags would be, but I assume it's to further specify a post under its category. For my post about a new iPhone, I would add in tags such as "shopping" or "new".
4) Editor usability	"Please type your question into the editor. As you do this, what do you notice about the editor's features? Is it clear how to format or structure your message?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	Comment(s): It was very clear to understand how the text editor works and functions identically with traditional text editors, so it felt

		familiar and natural to use for me. I also love the inclusion of markdown editing, but the button to switch between standard and markdown was a bit obscure until I hovered over it to check.					
5) Preview / feedback	“Before posting, do you see any way to preview how your message will look? If so, how useful is the preview? If not, what would you expect to see?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I think the standard text editor already has a preview of my formatted text which makes things straightforward and the markdown editor also gives a nice side by side preview, but I'm not as sure about the overall post preview including my category and included tags and how that will look.					
6) Save/validation	“Imagine you've written your post but accidentally left a field blank. What happens if you try to save or post it? Is the feedback clear?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): When I leave a field blank the feedback gives a clear indication of where I've missed something and why, e.g. a post can't not have a topic. It was also nice that the tags are explicitly labelled as optional when I initially create a post so it makes things easier in that sense too.					
7) Confidence to publish	“Looking at your post now, how confident do you feel about publishing it? Do you feel ready to share it with the community, or are you uncertain?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): In terms of publishing confidence, the post form ensures that I filled in all the required fields before I can post and gives me a preview of what my post text will look like, so I feel confident about publishing my post.					

8) Post-publish reflection	“Now that you’ve published your post, how do you know it worked? What feedback do you see that tells you the post is live and visible to others?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The website took me to a new page showing my newly created post which clearly told me that it worked. It also has a series of popup instructions that tell me how I can further manage my post which is useful.					

TASK 3: Find a discussion about kitchen appliances

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
9) Findability	“Imagine you want to read what people are saying about kitchen appliances. Where would you go first on this site to start looking?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I would look for some sort of filtering feature to sort or filter by category or tags. It was fairly simple to find but there was a lack of icons.					
10) Info scent	“As you look at the available links, categories, or headings, what makes you think one of these will lead to kitchen appliance discussions?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The categories give a nice short explanation of the sort of posts that would be included in them, and the category names themselves are comprehensive too. So it was easy to narrow down and find a discussion on kitchen appliances.					
11) Search quality	“Please try using the search function to look for ‘kitchen	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	appliances.' How do the results compare with what you expected?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): The search results seem to be less relevant than the topic filtering, since it looks like it searched for text occurrences.						
12) Filters/sort	"If you want to narrow the results, what filters or sorting options do you see? How helpful are they in finding the right discussion?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): I needed to go into advanced filters to filter down the search, and that's when it allowed me to get a better search result for kitchen appliance related posts. It gave a very good result after doing the advanced filtering.						
13) Category clarity	"Do the site's categories make sense for finding a topic like kitchen appliances? Which one seems the best fit, and why?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): The categories are generally quite clear although they do not have a description like they do in other places. It seems like Home and Living is the most suitable category, since kitchen appliances are relevant to that category label.						
14) Tag clarity	"Do any tags stand out as helpful for this kind of topic? Are the tags clear enough to guide you to the right posts?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): The tags are helpful, such as the shopping tag which helps me narrow my search down to shopping for kitchen appliances.						
15) Page scanning	"Now that you're on the results or category page, how easy is it to scan and identify	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	

	a relevant discussion about kitchen appliances?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The post topics are clear and a small preview is given for the contents of the post, so it was easy to find a relevant post.					
16) Outcome utility	"Looking at the discussion you found, does it give you the kind of information you were hoping for? Why or why not?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was helpful. The search led me to a discussion that was relevant to what I was looking for.					

TASK 4: Reply to a thread

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
17) CTA discoverability	"Imagine you've read a post in a discussion and want to reply. What do you see on the page that suggests how to start your reply?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There's a large button and icons that says Reply under a post, so it's easy to navigate and find where to reply to a certain post.					
18) Target clarity	"As you begin replying, how clear is it who or what your reply will be directed to? Do you feel confident your response is going to the right place?" (NOTE: I could clearly tell who I was replying to)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was very clear and concise who and what I would be replying to.					

19) On-screen cues	“What cues do you notice on the screen that confirm you are in reply mode? Are these cues strong enough to reassure you?” (NOTE: The UI showed clear cues like).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is a large popup at the bottom that shows a section for what my reply will be, similar to the new topic post section, so the UI was simple.					
20) Context / quoting	“If you wanted to quote part of the original post for context, how would you do that? Is this option visible and clear?” (NOTE: It was clear how to quote or include context from the thread if needed).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was unclear on how to directly quote a post without copy and pasting the text.					
21) Editor usability	“Please type your reply into the editor. How does the writing experience feel to you? Is formatting or adding content intuitive?” (NOTE: The editor made it easy to type)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Apart from quoting the text editor is very intuitive, so it was easy to create a reply to the post.					
22) Preview / placement	“Before submitting, do you see any way to preview how your reply will look? Do you know where it will appear in the thread?” (NOTE: I could preview or understand where my reply would appear in the thread).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is a pretty standard preview similar to a new topic post, so it is easy to understand what my reply would look like once posted.					
23) Mentions / tagging	“If you wanted to mention another user in your reply, how would you do that? How	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	easy or difficult does it seem?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is no UI indication for mentioning someone, and I had to guess that I had to type in @ to mention someone.					
24) System feedback	"After posting your reply, what feedback do you see that tells you it was successful? How confident are you that others can now see your reply?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It takes me to the bottom of the discussion and shows my reply in the thread, so I'm confident that others would be able to see my reply.					

TASK 5: Flag an inappropriate comment

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
25) Entry discoverability	"Imagine you've just seen a comment that you think breaks the community rules. What would you do first to flag or report it?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was easy to browse around the options to identify the flag/report option, which was hidden in the 3 dots icon.					
26) Reason	"When you try to report the comment, how clear are the options for explaining why you are flagging it? Do they match your expectations?" (NOTE: The report's reasons were clear and fit my situation).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The report options gave concise and clear reasons, and fit my situation (irrelevance), it was also good to know that there is an "other" option that allows me to type my					

		reasons in, although this was not available for the rest of the report options.					
27) Guidance / policy	“Do you see any guidance about what counts as inappropriate content? How would that affect your decision to report this comment?” (NOTE: Any brief guidance/policy hints helped me decide whether to report).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The descriptions under each report option give a nice hint about what sort of post would fall under what category of report, so it was simple and I felt well guided to the appropriate report option.					
28) Effort	“How much effort does it feel like to complete this reporting process? Does it seem quick and simple, or more complicated than you expected?” (NOTE: Reporting felt quick and straightforward).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The reporting process is extremely quick and simple, so it was a low effort process. The explanations provided are not verbose and communicate each point well.					
29) Anonymity & trust	“Do you feel confident that your report will stay anonymous? How much do you trust the system to handle your report fairly?” (NOTE: I felt safe/anonymous reporting this comment).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is no indication of anonymity in the report process, so I don't exactly feel comfortable handing out a report.					
30) Confirmation	“After submitting your report, what feedback do you get? How do you know your report went through?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Clear feedback was given that my report was received, however there was nothing about how the report is really processed, so I am a bit lost in that regard. Additionally, there is no					

		indication of where I can check for updates on my reports.					
31) Reversibility	“If you realized you reported by mistake, how would you undo it? Do you see an option for cancelling or reversing the action?” (NOTE: It was clear how to undo/cancel if I changed my mind)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There was no mention of being able to undo or cancel a report before, during or after the reporting process, so it is unclear whether I am actually able to undo a report, let alone how to do it if I changed my mind.					
32) Expected outcome	“What do you expect will happen next with the report you just made? Do you think you’ll be updated, and how soon?” (NOTE: I understand what happens next)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is no indication of what happens after they send out a report apart from the statement that they will review it as soon as possible, so I don't know or understand what will happen next.					

Post-Test Questions

Task	Overall Difficulty (Out of 5)	Time	Comments
1	3	Around 10 minuets	
2	2-3	Around 10-15 minuets	
3	3-4	10 minuets	
4	3-4	10 minuets	
5	4	5 minuets	

Participant C

Name: Jane

Age: 19

Gender: Female

Country of Birth: China

Australian Citizen: YES / **NO**

Question	Response Options
What operating system do you use most often?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Android Phone and Tablet, Windows
What web browser do you normally use?	<u>Comment(s):</u> QQ Browser, Bing, Google Chrome
Do you currently use any social media platforms?	☒ Yes / No
How often do you use social media?	☒ Daily
	☐ Weekly
	☐ Monthly
	☐ Rarely
	☐ Never
Which social media platforms do you use most frequently?	☒ Instagram
	☐ Facebook
	☐ Twitter (X)
	☐ Reddit
	☒ Other(s): YouTube, Wechat, BiliBili, and Douyin (the Chinese version of TikTok)
How many hours per week do you typically spend on social media?	☐ Less than 1 hour - 1 hour
	☐ 1 hour

	☐ 2-3 hours (a couple of hours) ☐ 4-6 hours (a few hours) ☒ 9+ hours
Do you prefer using social media on mobile or desktop?	Comment(s): Both mobile and desktop
What are your main reasons for using social media? (e.g., socialising, news, work, community)	Comment(s): Socializing with friends and family, community engagement, and school related work.
Have you ever used a decentralised social platform before (e.g., Mastodon, PeerTube, Lemmy)?	☒ Yes / No I have no idea what that is
On a scale of 1–5, how comfortable do you feel trying new social platforms?	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5
☒ 1 = not comfortable and 5 = comfortable	

TASK 1: Sign up as a new user

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) Locate “Sign Up” option on homepage	“Imagine you are visiting the CHOICE Community for the first time and want to join the platform. Please show me how you would start the registration process.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		<u>Comment(s)</u> : IP issue was annoying. The big green button saying Join Community made things easy to navigate.					
2) Form clarity	“Now that you have opened the sign-up page, what are your first impressions of the	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	form? Is it clear what information you need to provide?" (NOTE: Field labels & placeholders were clear?)	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): No notes very simple and easy to understand :)					
3) Password rules	"Before you enter a password, take a look at the password requirements. Are they clear to you? Please describe what you expect the rules to be." (NOTE: Password requirements were visible & understandable?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The requirements did not show up immediately and only once you started typing your PW in.					
4) Enter password	"Please create a password for your new account. Tell me what you are thinking as you enter it." If there is an ERROR , does it tell you how to fix it?	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was unsure of what the actual password requirements were as it only reveals the missing requirements as you type it in, so I wasn't sure if I was typing in a valid password.					
5) Submit form with missing/invalid info	"Imagine you accidentally skipped a required field. Please submit the form and see what happens. After knowing this, I knew what would happen next (e.g., email verify)"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The form gives good instructions when you miss information and tells you what happens next, for example it tells you that they will send an email confirmation.					
6) Wait for confirmation	"Now that you have submitted the form, what do you expect will happen next? Please describe what feedback you	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

	see on the screen. I felt comfortable sharing info here.”	Comment(s): I expected an email confirmation to be sent to me, and the screen also told me that as well, it also gave the option to resend the confirmation email which is nice. I was comfortable sharing info.					
7) Review privacy statement	“Before finalizing your account, please check if you can find any information about privacy or how your data will be used. What are your impressions? (E.g., Signing up felt quick, not too many steps/clicks).”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was able to find information on privacy and data usage easily at the bottom of the page, although the text is small. Signing up itself was quick and didn't require much effort.					
8) Evaluate entire process	“Now that you have completed the sign-up steps, how would you describe the overall process? Was it easy, confusing, or time-consuming? Please explain to the interviewer or leave a comment.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Very simple and straightforward. It wasn't confusing or time consuming at all. The interface was very simple and clearly communicated what I needed, but the password requirements not being all present was annoying.					

TASK 2: Create a new post asking for advice (Repeat at the End)

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) CTA discoverability	“Imagine you want to ask the community for advice. How would you start creating a new post? Please show me where you would begin. Is the New Topic/Post button easy to find?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): I would try to find a button that includes the phrase "New ____". It was fairly simple to find the New Topic button but the colour and size made it a bit more obscured than it should be. It was a bit small and was grey over a white background.					
2) Category choice	“Now that you’re creating a post, how do you decide which category to place it in? Please describe your thought process.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was helpful that each category gave a short description of the sort of stuff that would fall under it, so it helped me narrow down the category of my post. My thought process was that I saw a text box called General and I clicked it assuming it would be a drop down menu or text box to input the category.					
3) Tagging	“Do you see an option to add tags to your post? What tags would you add, and how easy or difficult is it to understand how tagging works here?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It is easy to add in tags for my post, although I'm not entirely sure what the purpose of tags would be, but I assume it's to further specify a post under its category. For my post about a new iPhone, I would add in tags such as "shopping" or "new".					
4) Editor usability	“Please type your question into the editor. As you do this, what do you notice about the editor’s features? Is it clear how to format or structure your message?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was very clear to understand how the text editor works and functions identically with traditional text editors, so it felt familiar and natural to use for me. I also love the inclusion of markdown editing, but the button to					

		switch between standard and markdown was a bit obscure until I hovered over it to check.					
5) Preview/feedback	“Before posting, do you see any way to preview how your message will look? If so, how useful is the preview? If not, what would you expect to see?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I think the standard text editor already has a preview of my formatted text which makes things straightforward and the markdown editor also gives a nice side by side preview, but I'm not as sure about the overall post preview including my category and included tags and how that will look.					
6) Save/validation	“Imagine you've written your post but accidentally left a field blank. What happens if you try to save or post it? Is the feedback clear?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): When I leave a field blank the feedback gives a clear indication of where I've missed something and why, e.g. a post can't not have a topic. It was also nice that the tags are explicitly labelled as optional when I initially create a post so it makes things easier in that sense too.					
7) Confidence to publish	“Looking at your post now, how confident do you feel about publishing it? Do you feel ready to share it with the community, or are you uncertain?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): In terms of publishing confidence, the post form ensures that I filled in all the required fields before I can post and gives me a preview of what my post text will look like, so I feel confident about publishing my post.					
8) Post-publish reflection	“Now that you've published your post, how do you know it worked? What feedback do	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	you see that tells you the post is live and visible to others?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The website took me to a new page showing my newly created post which clearly told me that it worked. It also has a series of popup instructions that tell me how I can further manage my post which is useful.					

TASK 3: Find a discussion about kitchen appliances

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
9) Findability	“Imagine you want to read what people are saying about kitchen appliances. Where would you go first on this site to start looking?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I would look for some sort of filtering feature to sort or filter by category or tags. It was fairly simple to find but there was a lack of icons.					
10) Info scent	“As you look at the available links, categories, or headings, what makes you think one of these will lead to kitchen appliance discussions?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The current categorization system presents a potential UX problem. Users may struggle to classify items like kitchen appliances, as they could logically fall under both 'electricity' (due to their power source) and 'food' (due to their use). This ambiguity could lead to misclassification and a frustrating user experience. In my opinion, your team should consider revising the category definitions or implementing a more intuitive classification system to avoid this confusion.					

11) Search quality	“Please try using the search function to look for ‘kitchen appliances.’ How do the results compare with what you expected?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The search results seem to be less relevant than the topic filtering, since it looks like it searched for text occurrences.					
12) Filters/sort	“If you want to narrow the results, what filters or sorting options do you see? How helpful are they in finding the right discussion?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The current filtering logic appears overly restrictive, leading to a limited and potentially unrepresentative selection of posts. While the intention behind 'bad filters' is understood, the present implementation seems to prioritize strictly announced posts at the expense of other potentially relevant and insightful content. Expanding the criteria for relevant posts could significantly enhance the user experience and provide a more comprehensive view of the topic.					
13) Category clarity	“Do the site’s categories make sense for finding a topic like kitchen appliances? Which one seems the best fit, and why?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): No, this does not make any sense, I cannot find the best fit as either electricity and food can be suitable, creating a confusing user experience. The core issue is the lack of clarity regarding the criteria for determining the best fit. I was unable to determine the most suitable option. Please specify whether electricity or food should be prioritized based on [criteria, e.g., cost, availability, efficiency].					
14) Tag clarity	“Do any tags stand out as helpful for this kind of topic? Are the tags clear enough to	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	guide you to the right posts?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The tags are helpful, such as the shopping tag which helps me narrow my search down to shopping for kitchen appliances.					
15) Page scanning	"Now that you're on the results or category page, how easy is it to scan and identify a relevant discussion about kitchen appliances?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The post topics are clear and a small preview is given for the contents of the post, so it was easy to find a relevant post.					
16) Outcome utility	"Looking at the discussion you found, does it give you the kind of information you were hoping for? Why or why not?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The current user experience presents significant challenges. The website's utility is notably poor, leading to a frustrating and ultimately unproductive experience for users. A comprehensive review and redesign of the user interface and overall functionality are highly recommended to address these shortcomings.					

TASK 4: Reply to a thread

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
17) CTA discoverability	"Imagine you've read a post in a discussion and want to reply. What do you see on the page that suggests how to start your reply?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): There is the 'reply' button which is clear to see.					
18) Target clarity	“As you begin replying, how clear is it who or what your reply will be directed to? Do you feel confident your response is going to the right place?” (NOTE: I could clearly tell who I was replying to)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was very clear and concise who and what I would be replying to.					
19) On-screen cues	“What cues do you notice on the screen that confirm you are in reply mode? Are these cues strong enough to reassure you?” (NOTE: The UI showed clear cues like).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The consistent queues suggest high demand; however, the instructional design could benefit from a more visually engaging presentation. Enhancing the color palette and overall aesthetic would help the instructions stand out and improve user comprehension.					
20) Context/quoting	“If you wanted to quote part of the original post for context, how would you do that? Is this option visible and clear?” (NOTE: It was clear how to quote or include context from the thread if needed).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was struggling to complete this step as I was explaining my frustration to Proud. I think to improve user experience, the website should provide an initial tutorial or clear visual cues indicating that selecting text activates the quote functionality. Currently, users must discover this feature independently, which can be frustrating.					
21) Editor usability	“Please type your reply into the editor. How does the writing experience feel to you? Is formatting or adding	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	content intuitive?" (NOTE: The editor made it easy to type)	Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): Apart from quoting the text editor is very intuitive, so it was easy to create a reply to the post.						
22) Preview / placement	“Before submitting, do you see any way to preview how your reply will look? Do you know where it will appear in the thread?” (NOTE: I could preview or understand where my reply would appear in the thread).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): I'm uncertain about where this content will appear in relation to the original post, as there is no preview available. A preview feature would provide necessary confirmation and improve user confidence.						
23) Mentions / tagging	“If you wanted to mention another user in your reply, how would you do that? How easy or difficult does it seem?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): The website lacks clear guidance on how to use the '@' symbol to activate the mention function. Users unfamiliar with this convention may not realize how to properly tag others.						
24) System feedback	“After posting your reply, what feedback do you see that tells you it was successful? How confident are you that others can now see your reply?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E	
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5	
		Comment(s): It takes me to the bottom of the discussion and shows my reply in the thread, so I'm confident that others would be able to see my reply.						

TASK 5: Flag an inappropriate comment

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
25) Entry discoverability	“Imagine you’ve just seen a comment that you think breaks the community rules. What would you do first to flag or report it?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I didn't find the ways to flag others' comments, this suggests a usability issue. As a user myself, I am having difficulty locating the comment flagging feature. To improve the UX, I'd consider re-wording and re-positioning the flag/report comment option. Perhaps a more direct phrase like 'Report Comment' or 'Flag as Inappropriate' would be clearer. Visually speaking, perhaps ensure the flagging option is easily discoverable, possibly near the comment itself, using a recognizable icon (e.g., a flag or an ellipsis menu with 'Report' as an option). Adding a brief tooltip or label explaining the purpose of the flag/report feature could also be beneficial.					
26) Reason	“When you try to report the comment, how clear are the options for explaining why you are flagging it? Do they match your expectations?” (NOTE: The report's reasons were clear and fit my situation).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The option to report or flag comments from other users is not readily apparent. I was unable to locate it.					
27) Guidance / policy	“Do you see any guidance about what counts as inappropriate content? How would that affect your decision to report this comment?” (NOTE: Any brief guidance/policy hints helped me decide whether to report).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I cannot find any guidance.					

28) Effort	“How much effort does it feel like to complete this reporting process? Does it seem quick and simple, or more complicated than you expected?” (NOTE: Reporting felt quick and straightforward).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was more of a complication; I didn't expect it to be this complicated.					
29) Anonymity & trust	“Do you feel confident that your report will stay anonymous? How much do you trust the system to handle your report fairly?” (NOTE: I felt safe/anonymous reporting this comment).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I'm concerned that my personal information has been exposed through the comments section, compromising my privacy.					
30) Confirmation	“After submitting your report, what feedback do you get? How do you know your report went through?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I didn't see any feedback.					
31) Reversibility	“If you realized you reported by mistake, how would you undo it? Do you see an option for cancelling or reversing the action?” (NOTE: It was clear how to undo/cancel if I changed my mind)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was pretty clear to see.					
32) Expected outcome	“What do you expect will happen next with the report you just made? Do you think you'll be updated, and how soon?” (NOTE: I understand what happens next)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): There is no indication of what happens after they send out a report apart from the statement that they will review it as soon as possible, so I don't know or understand what will happen next.
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Post-Test Questions

Task	Overall Difficulty (Out of 5)	Time	Comments
1	1	Less than 5 minuets	
2	2-3	Less than 10 minuets	
3	3-4	Around 10 minutes	
4	5	Around 15 minuets	
5	4	Around 15 minuets	

Participant D

Name: Ariana

Age: 23

Gender: Female

Country of Birth: South Africa

Australian Citizen: YES / **NO**

Question	Response Options
What operating system do you use most often?	Comment(s): Android Phone and Tablet, Windows
What web browser do you normally use?	Comment(s): QQ Browser, Bing, Google Chrome

Do you currently use any social media platforms?	☒ Yes / No
How often do you use social media?	☒ Daily
	☐ Weekly
	☐ Monthly
	☐ Rarely
	☐ Never
Which social media platforms do you use most frequently?	☒ Instagram
	☐ Facebook
	☐ Twitter (X)
	☐ Reddit
	☒ Other(s): YouTube, Wechat, BiliBili, and Douyin (the Chinese version of TikTok)
How many hours per week do you typically spend on social media?	☐ Less than 1 hour - 1 hour
	☐ 1 hour
	☐ 2-3 hours (a couple of hours)
	☐ 4-6 hours (a few hours)
	☒ 9+ hours
Do you prefer using social media on mobile or desktop?	<u>Comment(s):</u> Both mobile and desktop
What are your main reasons for using social media? (e.g., socialising, news, work, community)	<u>Comment(s):</u> Socializing with friends and family, community engagement, and school related work.
Have you ever used a decentralised social platform before (e.g., Mastodon, PeerTube, Lemmy)?	☒ Yes / No I have no idea what that is

On a scale of 1–5, how comfortable do you feel trying new social platforms? ☒ 1 = not comfortable and 5 = comfortable	☐ 1
	☐ 2
	☐ 3
	☐ 4
	☒ 5

TASK 1: Sign up as a new user

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) Locate “Sign Up” option on homepage	“Imagine you are visiting the CHOICE Community for the first time and want to join the platform. Please show me how you would start the registration process.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): IP issue was annoying. The big green button saying Join Community made things easy to navigate.					
2) Form clarity	“Now that you have opened the sign-up page, what are your first impressions of the form? Is it clear what information you need to provide?” (NOTE: Field labels & placeholders were clear?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): No notes very simple and easy to understand :)					
3) Password rules	“Before you enter a password, take a look at the password requirements. Are they clear to you? Please describe what you expect the rules to be.” (NOTE: Password requirements were visible & understandable?)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): The requirements did not show up immediately and only once you started typing your PW in.					
4) Enter password	“Please create a password for your new account. Tell me what you are thinking as you enter it.” If there is an ERROR , does it tell you how to fix it?	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was unsure of what the actual password requirements were as it only reveals the missing requirements as you type it in, so I wasn't sure if I was typing in a valid password.					
5) Submit form with missing/invalid info	“Imagine you accidentally skipped a required field. Please submit the form and see what happens. After knowing this, I knew what would happen next (e.g., email verify)”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The form gives good instructions when you miss information and tells you what happens next, for example it tells you that they will send an email confirmation.					
6) Wait for confirmation	“Now that you have submitted the form, what do you expect will happen next? Please describe what feedback you see on the screen. I felt comfortable sharing info here.”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I expected an email confirmation to be sent to me, and the screen also told me that as well, it also gave the option to resend the confirmation email which is nice. I was comfortable sharing info.					
7) Review privacy statement	“Before finalizing your account, please check if you can find any information about privacy or how your data will	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	be used. What are your impressions? (E.g., Signing up felt quick, not too many steps/clicks)."	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was able to find information on privacy and data usage easily at the bottom of the page, although the text is small. Signing up itself was quick and didn't require much effort.					
8) Evaluate entire process	"Now that you have completed the sign-up steps, how would you describe the overall process? Was it easy, confusing, or time-consuming? Please explain to the interviewer or leave a comment."	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Very simple and straightforward. It wasn't confusing or time consuming at all. The interface was very simple and clearly communicated what I needed, but the password requirements not being all present was annoying.					

TASK 2: Create a new post asking for advice (Repeat at the End)

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
1) CTA discoverability	"Imagine you want to ask the community for advice. How would you start creating a new post? Please show me where you would begin. Is the New Topic/Post button easy to find?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I would try to find a button that includes the phrase "New ____". It was fairly simple to find the New Topic button but the colour and size made it a bit more obscured than it should be. It was a bit small and was grey over a white background.					
2) Category choice	"Now that you're creating a post, how do you decide which category to place it in? Please describe your thought process."	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): It was helpful that each category gave a short description of the sort of stuff that would fall under it, so it helped me narrow down the category of my post. My thought process was that I saw a text box called General and I clicked it assuming it would be a drop down menu or text box to input the category.					
3) Tagging	“Do you see an option to add tags to your post? What tags would you add, and how easy or difficult is it to understand how tagging works here?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It is easy to add in tags for my post, although I'm not entirely sure what the purpose of tags would be, but I assume it's to further specify a post under its category. For my post about a new iPhone, I would add in tags such as "shopping" or "new".					
4) Editor usability	“Please type your question into the editor. As you do this, what do you notice about the editor’s features? Is it clear how to format or structure your message?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was very clear to understand how the text editor works and functions identically with traditional text editors, so it felt familiar and natural to use for me. I also love the inclusion of markdown editing, but the button to switch between standard and markdown was a bit obscure until I hovered over it to check.					
5) Preview/feedback	“Before posting, do you see any way to preview how your message will look? If so, how useful is the preview? If not, what would you expect to see?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): I think the standard text editor already has a preview of my formatted text which makes things straightforward and the markdown editor also gives a nice side by side preview, but I'm not as sure about the overall post preview including my category and included tags and how that will look.					
6) Save/validation	“Imagine you’ve written your post but accidentally left a field blank. What happens if you try to save or post it? Is the feedback clear?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): When I leave a field blank the feedback gives a clear indication of where I've missed something and why, e.g. a post can't not have a topic. It was also nice that the tags are explicitly labelled as optional when I initially create a post so it makes things easier in that sense too.					
7) Confidence to publish	“Looking at your post now, how confident do you feel about publishing it? Do you feel ready to share it with the community, or are you uncertain?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): In terms of publishing confidence, the post form ensures that I filled in all the required fields before I can post and gives me a preview of what my post text will look like, so I feel confident about publishing my post.					
8) Post-publish reflection	“Now that you’ve published your post, how do you know it worked? What feedback do you see that tells you the post is live and visible to others?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The website took me to a new page showing my newly created post which clearly told me that it worked. It also has a series of popup instructions that tell me how I can further manage my post which is useful.					

TASK 3: Find a discussion about kitchen appliances

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
9) Findability	“Imagine you want to read what people are saying about kitchen appliances. Where would you go first on this site to start looking?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I would look for some sort of filtering feature to sort or filter by category or tags. It was fairly simple to find but there was a lack of icons.					
10) Info scent	“As you look at the available links, categories, or headings, what makes you think one of these will lead to kitchen appliance discussions?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Ratings	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The current categorization system presents a potential UX problem. Users may struggle to classify items like kitchen appliances, as they could logically fall under both 'electricity' (due to their power source) and 'food' (due to their use). This ambiguity could lead to misclassification and a frustrating user experience. In my opinion, your team should consider revising the category definitions or implementing a more intuitive classification system to avoid this confusion.					
11) Search quality	“Please try using the search function to look for ‘kitchen appliances.’ How do the results compare with what you expected?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The search results seem to be less relevant than the topic filtering, since it looks like it searched for text occurrences.					

12) Filters/sort	“If you want to narrow the results, what filters or sorting options do you see? How helpful are they in finding the right discussion?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The current filtering logic appears overly restrictive, leading to a limited and potentially unrepresentative selection of posts. While the intention behind 'bad filters' is understood, the present implementation seems to prioritize strictly announced posts at the expense of other potentially relevant and insightful content. Expanding the criteria for relevant posts could significantly enhance the user experience and provide a more comprehensive view of the topic.					
13) Category clarity	“Do the site’s categories make sense for finding a topic like kitchen appliances? Which one seems the best fit, and why?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): No, this does not make any sense, I cannot find the best fit as either electricity and food can be suitable, creating a confusing user experience. The core issue is the lack of clarity regarding the criteria for determining the best fit. I was unable to determine the most suitable option. Please specify whether electricity or food should be prioritized based on [criteria, e.g., cost, availability, efficiency].					
14) Tag clarity	“Do any tags stand out as helpful for this kind of topic? Are the tags clear enough to guide you to the right posts?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The tags are helpful, such as the shopping tag which helps me narrow my search down to shopping for kitchen appliances.					
15) Page scanning	“Now that you’re on the results or category page, how easy is it to scan and	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	identify a relevant discussion about kitchen appliances?"	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The post topics are clear and a small preview is given for the contents of the post, so it was easy to find a relevant post.					
16) Outcome utility	"Looking at the discussion you found, does it give you the kind of information you were hoping for? Why or why not?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The current user experience presents significant challenges. The website's utility is notably poor, leading to a frustrating and ultimately unproductive experience for users. A comprehensive review and redesign of the user interface and overall functionality are highly recommended to address these shortcomings.					

TASK 4: Reply to a thread

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
17) CTA discoverability	"Imagine you've read a post in a discussion and want to reply. What do you see on the page that suggests how to start your reply?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is the 'reply' button which is clear to see.					
18) Target clarity	"As you begin replying, how clear is it who or what your reply will be directed to? Do you feel confident your response is going to the right place?" (NOTE: I could	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

	clearly tell who I was replying to)	Comment(s): It was very clear and concise who and what I would be replying to.					
19) On-screen cues	“What cues do you notice on the screen that confirm you are in reply mode? Are these cues strong enough to reassure you?” (NOTE: The UI showed clear cues like).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The consistent queues suggest high demand; however, the instructional design could benefit from a more visually engaging presentation. Enhancing the color palette and overall aesthetic would help the instructions stand out and improve user comprehension.					
20) Context/quoting	“If you wanted to quote part of the original post for context, how would you do that? Is this option visible and clear?” (NOTE: It was clear how to quote or include context from the thread if needed).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I was struggling to complete this step as I was explaining my frustration to Proud. I think to improve user experience, the website should provide an initial tutorial or clear visual cues indicating that selecting text activates the quote functionality. Currently, users must discover this feature independently, which can be frustrating.					
21) Editor usability	“Please type your reply into the editor. How does the writing experience feel to you? Is formatting or adding content intuitive?” (NOTE: The editor made it easy to type)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): Apart from quoting the text editor is very intuitive, so it was easy to create a reply to the post.					
22) Preview / placement	“Before submitting, do you see any way to preview how your reply will look? Do you	Participant	A	B	C	D	E

	know where it will appear in the thread?" (NOTE: I could preview or understand where my reply would appear in the thread).	Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I'm uncertain about where this content will appear in relation to the original post, as there is no preview available. A preview feature would provide necessary confirmation and improve user confidence.					
23) Mentions / tagging	"If you wanted to mention another user in your reply, how would you do that? How easy or difficult does it seem?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The website lacks clear guidance on how to use the '@' symbol to activate the mention function. Users unfamiliar with this convention may not realize how to properly tag others.					
24) System feedback	"After posting your reply, what feedback do you see that tells you it was successful? How confident are you that others can now see your reply?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It takes me to the bottom of the discussion and shows my reply in the thread, so I'm confident that others would be able to see my reply.					

TASK 5: Flag an inappropriate comment

Step / Action	Question Prompt	Scale: Strongly Disagree (1) → Strongly Agree (5)					
25) Entry discoverability	"Imagine you've just seen a comment that you think breaks the community rules. What would you do first to flag or report it?"	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5

		Comment(s): I didn't find the ways to flag others' comments, this suggests a usability issue. As a user myself, I am having difficulty locating the comment flagging feature. To improve the UX, I'd consider re-wording and re-positioning the flag/report comment option. Perhaps a more direct phrase like 'Report Comment' or 'Flag as Inappropriate' would be clearer. Visually speaking, perhaps ensure the flagging option is easily discoverable, possibly near the comment itself, using a recognizable icon (e.g., a flag or an ellipsis menu with 'Report' as an option). Adding a brief tooltip or label explaining the purpose of the flag/report feature could also be beneficial.					
26) Reason	“When you try to report the comment, how clear are the options for explaining why you are flagging it? Do they match your expectations?” (NOTE: The report's reasons were clear and fit my situation).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): The option to report or flag comments from other users is not readily apparent. I was unable to locate it.					
27) Guidance / policy	“Do you see any guidance about what counts as inappropriate content? How would that affect your decision to report this comment?” (NOTE: Any brief guidance/policy hints helped me decide whether to report).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I cannot find any guidance.					
28) Effort	“How much effort does it feel like to complete this reporting process? Does it seem quick and simple, or more complicated than you expected?” (NOTE: Reporting felt quick and straightforward).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was more of a complication; I didn't expect it to be this complicated.					

29) Anonymity & trust	“Do you feel confident that your report will stay anonymous? How much do you trust the system to handle your report fairly?” (NOTE: I felt safe/anonymous reporting this comment).	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I'm concerned that my personal information has been exposed through the comments section, compromising my privacy.					
30) Confirmation	“After submitting your report, what feedback do you get? How do you know your report went through?”	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): I didn't see any feedback.					
31) Reversibility	“If you realized you reported by mistake, how would you undo it? Do you see an option for cancelling or reversing the action?” (NOTE: It was clear how to undo/cancel if I changed my mind)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): It was pretty clear to see.					
32) Expected outcome	“What do you expect will happen next with the report you just made? Do you think you'll be updated, and how soon?” (NOTE: I understand what happens next)	Participant	A	B	C	D	E
		Rating	1	2	3	4	5
		Comment(s): There is no indication of what happens after they send out a report apart from the statement that they will review it as soon as possible, so I don't know or understand what will happen next.					

Post-Test Questions

Task	Overall Difficulty (Out of 5)	Time	Comments
1	1	Less than 5 minuets	
2	2-3	Less than 10 minuets	
3	3-4	Around 10 minutes	
4	5	Around 15 minuets	
5	4	Around 15 minuets	

Raw Data: Footage

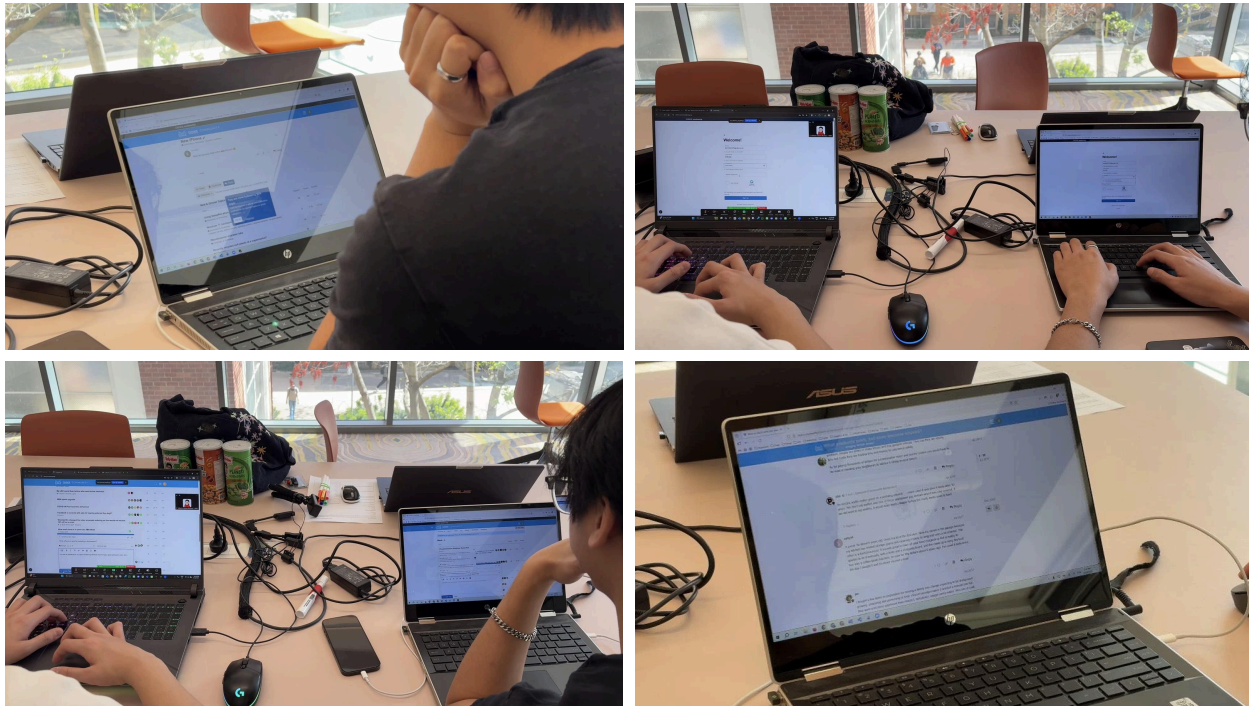


Figure 23-26: Participants exploring the Choice Community Website

Raw Data: Screenshots

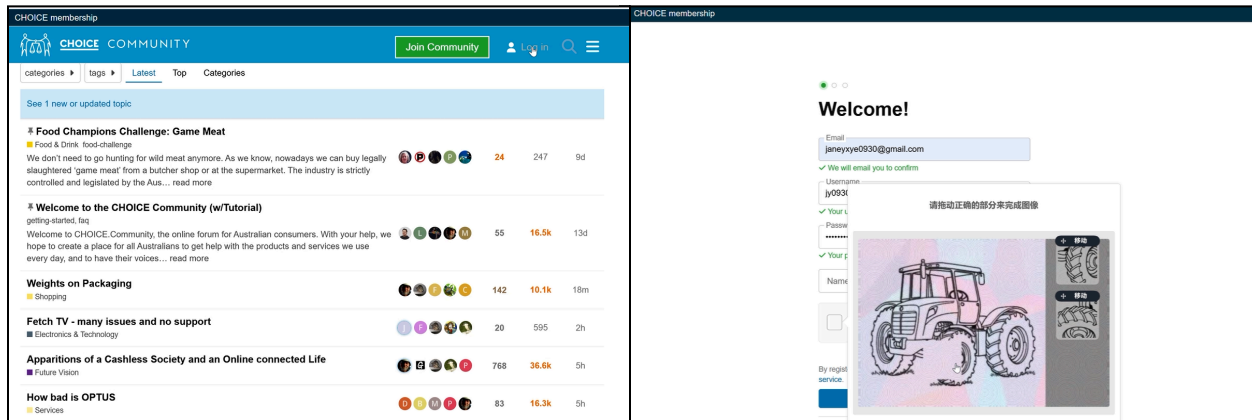


Figure 27-28: Participants completing their first task

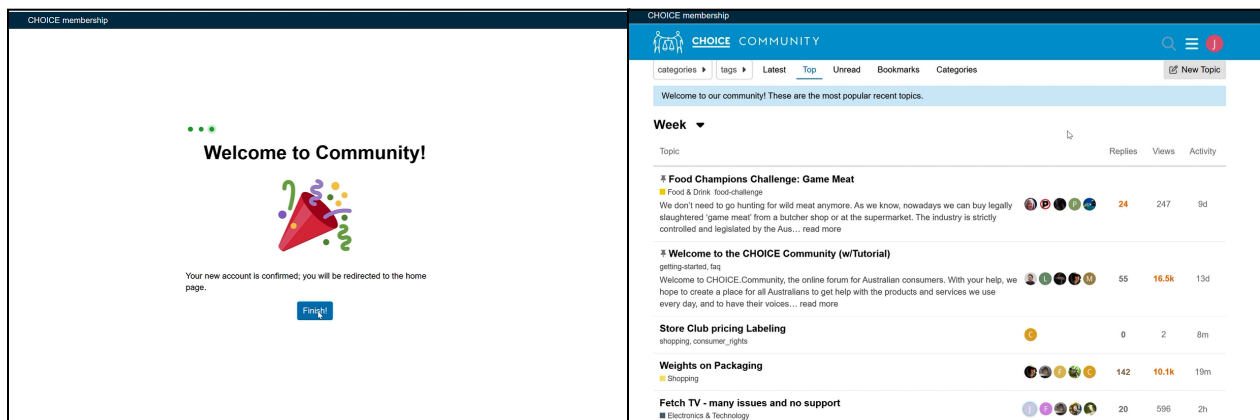
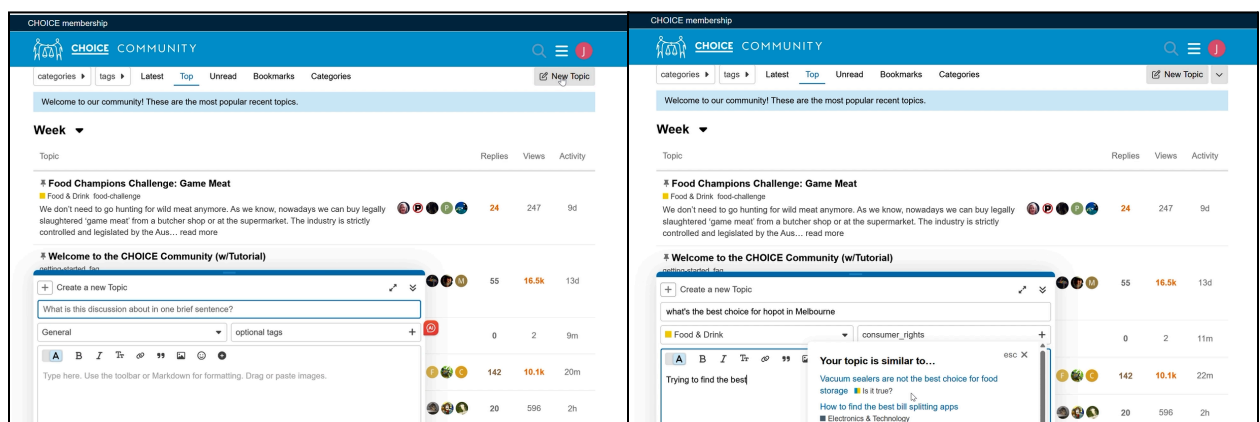


Figure 29-30: After each participants completed Task 1, they have arrived at the landing page of Choice Community



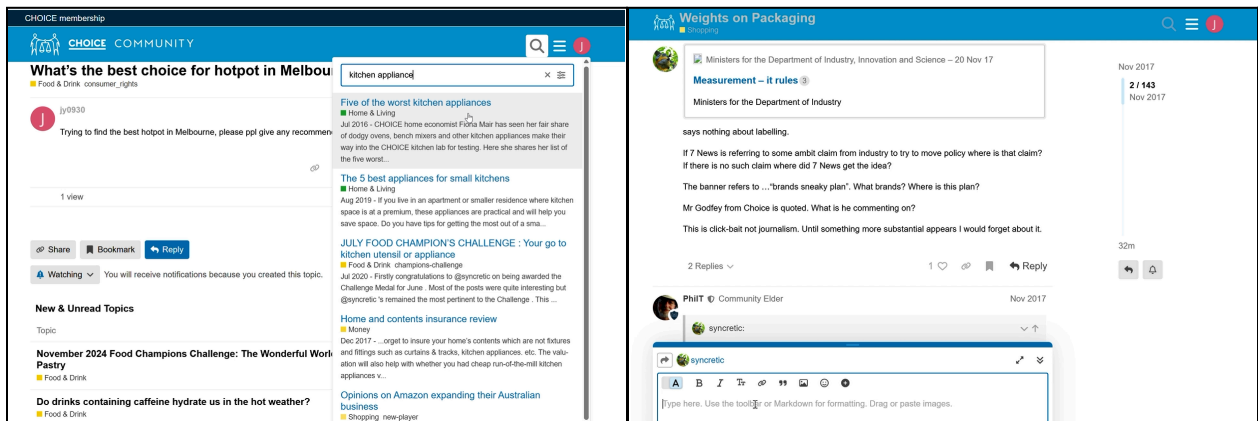


Figure 31-34: Completing Task 2, 3, 4, and 5

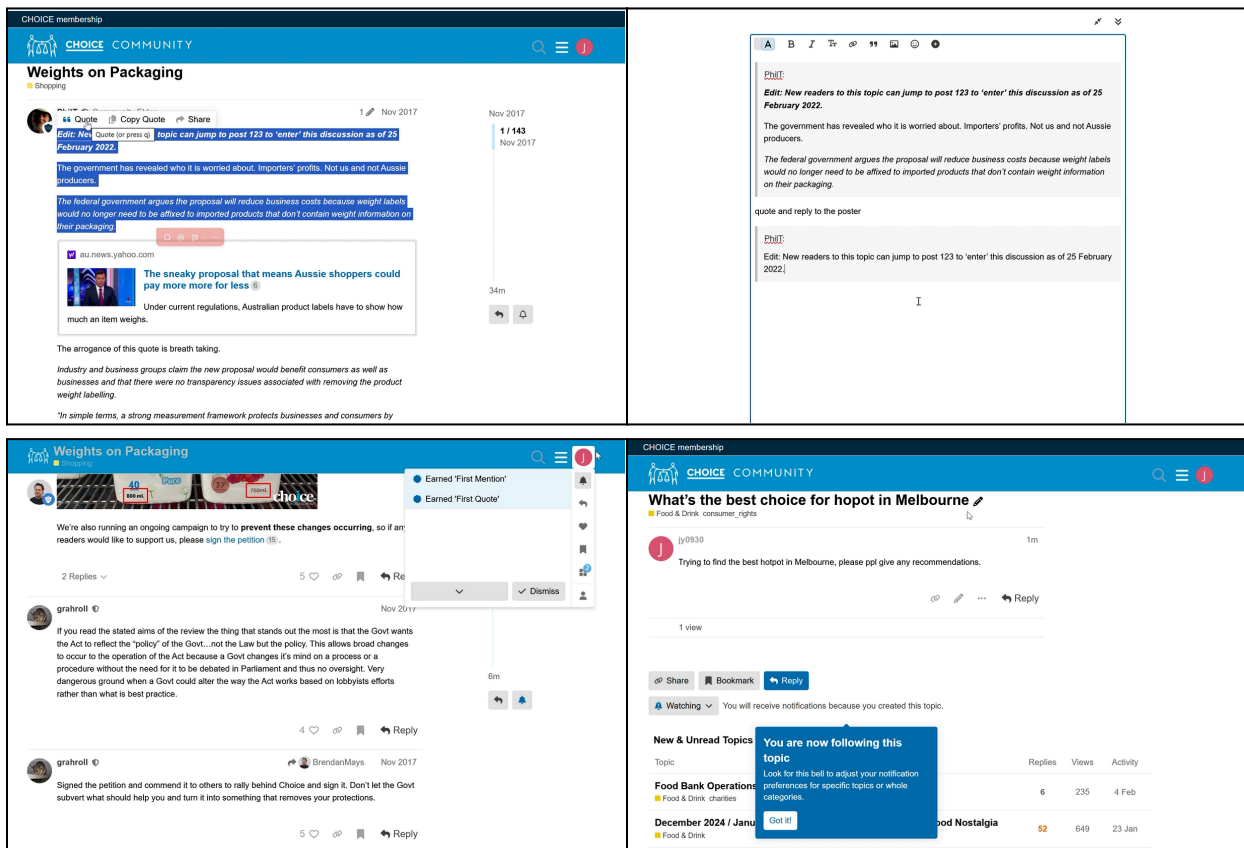


Figure 35-38: Participants completed all 5 tasks

Findings from in-person interviews

Visibility: In-person interviews align the "eyes–hands–mind" chain of evidence: you can see gaze regressions, posture shifts, and pointer tails at the same time, and then assess whether a stumble is caused by attention competition (header login vs. hero CTA), confusing metaphors (icon/label mismatch), or hierarchy noise. Set light observation codes with thresholds (e.g., hover >1.5s = micro-pause; three reciprocating scrolls = wayfinding; page zoom = accessibility issue). Use a neutral probe at critical points—"Were you looking for the entry point, or checking that this is the entry point? —to turn nebulous reluctance into a definite cause, and to separate "can't find" (discoverability) from "can't parse" (comprehensibility).

Immediacy: The core value is turning symptoms into actionable design levers in the moment. When a participant says "I don't know if I should post," don't wait for post-hoc inference—use three kinds of probes to come to solutions: clarifying ("What would you want to see right away so you'd feel confident?"), contrastive ("Would a 'Preview' be more useful than a firmer assurance of success?"), and constrained ("If we could put one thing here, what would it be?"). If helpful, produce a quick "shadow UI" with sticky notes (move a Preview button to the side of Publish, show tag suggestions underneath the field) and observe whether or not confusion is reduced and time-to-action is increased; log the participant's decision factors so "lack of confidence" becomes actual interaction and copywriting needs.

Credibility: Face-to-face rapport reduces social desirability bias, so people admit "I don't get this," "I'm afraid to flag," or "I'm not sure it's anonymous," revealing genuine safety needs (anonymity, reversibility, proof of follow-through). Open with non-judgmental framing ("We're evaluating the interface, not you"), allow silence, avoid leading prompts ("This is simple, right?"), and watch for self-censoring cues (delays, nervous laughs, seeking confirmation). Close with a reverse probe ("Which step made you most anxious?") and use short scales to capture perceived uncertainty/trust. The result is clearer inputs for trust-building design (explicit anonymity, undo windows).

Ethical safeguards: If hurtful or biased criticism is detected (like an automatic "spammer" flag), an in-person session permits immediate response through a red-line SOP: stop the task, automatically apologize, explain what to do next in uncomplicated terms, offer a break or leave, and honor the participant's choice. Provide a non-participant observer with training in listening for emotional signals (prolonged silence, leaning back, downward-looking eyes, accelerated speech slowdown) and to step in early; avoid causing re-exposure or "re-traumatization" of the participant. You could also ask them for their expectations of remediation (human judgment, direct appeal, apology/compensation) so ethics incidents become system changes protecting diverse newcomers.

Metric stability: In-person, you can normalize devices, browsers, zoom, viewport height, network, and input methods, eliminating environmental noise so time-to-find, error rate, undo rate, and completion rate can be easily compared. Calibrate display scaling and above-the-fold

area, disable extensions, flush caches to a common starting state, and set task anchors to high precision.

Decision support: In-person formats make it easy to collapse fuzzy desires into concrete structure and copy. Decompose the flow into cards (compose → choose category → add tags → preview → publish → confirm) and ask participants to reorder into their ideal sequence while explaining why; run tiny contrasts (5-second tests, forced A/B choices) on key control placement and wording to get directional signals fast. Use paired observation (moderator + note-taker) to mark friction and turning points without interrupting. Before closing, reconfirm participants' rationales—what, exactly, would raise confidence/safety/efficiency—so findings plug directly into iteration cadence with minimal back-and-forth.

Recommendations

The participant group provided good coverage of the range of community experience: established users demonstrated where the platform is at baseline, and newcomers opened up gaps in discoverability, guidance, and trust that threaten uptake. Although the five-member, convenience-sample limits external validity, the problem pattern and severity are consistent with accepted practice that small, well-moderated tests reveal most pressing issues (Nielsen, 1994; Rubin & Chisnell, 2008). Put simply, the findings are adequate to support actionable iteration as we plan further sampling at larger levels.

A major strength of the current study was the in-person, moderated design that maximized construct validity. Watches on the "eyes—hands—mind" sequence—gaze regressions, micro-pauses, pointer hesitations, posture shifts—helped to disambiguate if breakdowns were due to bad entry discoverability, terrible information scent, or confusing metaphors. Middlebrow, in-situ probes ("Were you looking for the entry point, or checking this was the entry point?") converted diffuse hesitation into concrete causes and also circumvented post-hoc misattribution. Paired observation (note-taker + moderator) increased reliability by instant concurrence of what constituted an error or uncertainty event.

The controlled laboratory environment also enhanced measurement quality. Normalizing viewport, device, and network conditions reduced environmental noise, making it possible to compare time-to-find, completion, and error measures more directly between participants. We synchronized task time with definite start/stop events and converted central tendency to medians and IQR in order to prevent long-tail artifacts—a move that maximizes internal validity and offers a stable basis for A/B and regression testing.

The most extreme restriction is an ethical matter: Participant A received an automatic abusive message referring to them as an "Indian spammer." Besides being factually incorrect and discriminatory, the event constitutes a P0 trust failure in onboarding, breaching the spirit of ISO 9241-210 (human-centred design) and best practice in inclusive UX (Barnum, 2020). This solitary instance created immediate attrition risk, reputation harm, and chilling effect for new

members—especially from diverse groups. Remediation should include red-line SOP (stop, apologize, explain, offer exit), rapid rollback or reconfiguring of automated filters, human review for edge cases, an appeals process, and post-incident communication that rebuilds dignity and confidence.

The results also show inclusion debt. Convenience recruitment under-represents older adults, low digital ability, and assistive technology users. Future rounds must employ a stratified recruitment matrix (experience × age × accessibility needs), employ screen-reader/keyboard testing, and employ WCAG 2.2 success criteria for UI changes. This will add to external validity and avoid over-fitting fixes to self-assured, experienced users.

Design implications directly map to familiar heuristics. Inadequate sign-up discoverability and inadequate status cues trigger "visibility of system status" and "recognition instead of recall." Password requirements only being shown on error violate "error prevention" and "help users recover." Posting and reply ambiguity reflect insufficient affordances and feedback. The reporting workflow lacks trust indicators (anonymity clarity, SLA visibility, progress/closure). Priority interventions should therefore: (1) enhance sign-up exposure and first-visit suggestions; (2) provide pre-emptive, in-line password prompts with instantaneous validation; (3) add tag/category suggestions and an obvious Preview next to Publish; (4) enhance reply scoping ("Replying to @User / to post #n"), success toasts, and anchored jump-backs; (5) default reporting anonymity (or make that obvious), provide a ticket/receipt, and expose handling status. Any change must start with success metrics (e.g., median TTF reduction, first-attempt success rate, perceived trust/confidence ratings) and guardrails to detect regressions.

Methodologically, we propose a multi-method follow-up: save moderated, in-person sessions for depth (cause discovery, ethics observation), augment with remote unmoderated tasks for breadth and quantitative muscle, and run targeted IA diagnostics (tree tests, card sorts, 5-second tests) to calibrate labels and navigation. Pre-register acceptance criteria per change (e.g., ≥20% reduction in time-to-sign-up; ≥80% accurate perception of reply target; ≥70% confidence that reports are anonymous/actuated) to close the build–measure–learn loop.

Finally, aligning product decisions with the mission of CHOICE is not shallow—It is strategic. A bias-free, open welcome process, clear system feedback, and consistent moderation are conditions for an authentic consumer-advocacy community. Correcting the discriminatory onboarding response alongside discoverability, direction, and reporting UX will improve both usability outcomes and the social contract of the platform.